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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, September 14, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TLRtmp0p8ok
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:14:49] It is 9am and I will now call this meeting to order. I'll note that I have approved the remote participation of Vice President Bill Hansen under the board bylaws and 2.2-3708.3 B3 of the Code of Virginia because his principal residence is more than 60 miles from the meeting location.

[00:15:09] At this time, I would ask everyone to join me in a moment of silence.

[00:15:29] and the Pledge of Allegiance, I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, and to the Republic of British and Spanish, one nation, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:15:52] Okay, can I get a motion to approve the agenda as presented, please? Megan. All right, Ms. Kilgore. Ms. Holton. Aye. Dr. Siebert. Aye.

[00:16:08] Mr. Hanson. See if you can hear me.

[00:16:14] Okay, we'll move on. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Thank you. Okay. And then staff has provided us with a draft of the minutes before the meeting. Can I get a motion to approve the minutes from our last meeting as presented? So moved. Second. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye.

[00:16:51] Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. At this time, I would like to take the opportunity to formally introduce to the public one of the governor's most recent appointees to the Board of Education, Ms. Mache Ashton.

[00:17:11] Ms. Ashton was unable to join us in our July meeting, but was with us in our special meeting in August, and Ms. Ashton is the founder and chief executive officer of Digital Pioneers Academy, which is a computer science-focused charter middle and high school that launched in 2018.

[00:17:32] She has also served as the CEO of the Newark Charter School Fund and held senior roles with new leaders for new schools, and the Knowledge is Power Program, and the New York City Department of Education. We're so grateful to have Ms. Ashton and her expertise as a part of our board now, and so if everyone would join me in welcoming Ms. Ashton, and would you like to take a moment to say a few words?

[00:18:00] Sure. Well, thank you all for having me. Thank you for being. And you forgot the most important part, which I started. Oops, sorry. Most important part of my bio is that I started as a special education teacher in Williamsburg, Virginia, and I'm incredibly proud to come back to serve. Thank you.

[00:18:23] Thank you. And so this morning, the board would also like to welcome members of the Virginia Department of Education's Aspiring Special Education Leadership Academy to the meeting today as our guests. Members are from a cohort 16, meaning this is the 16th year of the academy, which was established in 2008 with the purpose to influence the positive outcomes of Virginia students with disabilities by helping to identify and prepare potential leaders for future

[00:18:57] administrative positions in special education. As of August 2023, approximately 420 individuals have participated in the ASELA. The board would like to recognize Mr. Doug Cox, who leads the group, who leads this project for DOE in partnership with George Mason University. Mr. Cox.

[00:19:20] Thank you very much. Good morning, President Creasy, Dr. Coons, board members. It's always a pleasure for me to be here. We have been very grateful for ongoing interest in and support for our program by the Virginia Board of Education, and it's an absolute privilege for me to be here and to ask members of Cohort 16 to stand, please, and be recognized.

[00:19:54] Listen, Princey shared a good deal of information in her introduction. A couple of things, though, that you might find of interest is every one of these folks are here because they were identified as potential leaders by their school division.

[00:20:13] they were nominated by their school division, and their nomination carried the endorsement of their local special ed director and their division superintendent. So we have about an average of 20 amazing individuals each year, for which I am very fortunate to spend with them all year as we talk about important issues related to special education leadership.

[00:20:41] from the 20 are selected from an average of about 60 applications per year. So it's a very competitive process. One of the other things that I'd like to share with you is beginning with Cohort 7, we began a very formal evaluation program by the use of an instrument which measures the confidence level of the members of the academy in a pre and post test basis. And after all of the years that we've been doing that, I'm happy to report that every single year, there is a

[00:21:18] statistically significant increase in the confidence level of every member of the cohort and all of the factors that we look at. So I believe that I can say that it has been a successful programs so far to help identify the shortage not only of teachers but of special education leaders as well. So thank you again for having us and thank you once again for your ongoing support

[00:21:47] for what we do. Okay, we will move on to our public comment section of our meeting. As stated in the board's bylaws, it is the pleasure of the board to accept public comment on all matters related to public education in Virginia we ask that you please provide your name and affiliation at the beginning of your comments speakers shall limit their comments to three minutes and if you were here last month you've experienced our new timekeeping system so you'll notice the

[00:22:26] timer on the screen and so the screens begin at green and then at one minute your screen will turn yellow and then when your time is up your screen is going to turn red when your time is up please promptly close your remarks speakers may provide comments that are written or any other materials that you would like to provide the board to mr joe crook who's here in the front he's raising his hand and the department's regulatory and he is the department's regulatory

[00:23:01] and board coordinator he just started this week with us so um we're we're doing a trial by fire thing here um you can also of course email any of your comments to jim chapman who is our director of board relations um and so with that i will begin with speaker number one on our list today who is windy little it's windy little here okay candace lucas is candace lucas here all right

[00:23:40] how about kathy halverson no tammy c marianne jensen i'm here and after marianne jensen will be amy sneed good morning my name is marianne jensen and i am the chapter chair of moms for liberty in prince william county virginia i want to share our support for governors for the governor's model policy for transgender students specifically the guidelines for athletics it is no secret that outspoken female athletes like gaily riley gains

[00:24:19] have taken a bold stance in the fight to protect women's sports the model policy supports and protects female athletes who have worked so hard to develop their own sports programs to showcase the incredible talents of women we are all well familiar with riley gains and the the unfair treatment she received because of a biological male competing in her sport of swimming. However, these incidents are not isolated and limited to the high-profile cases. Have you heard about the female high school volleyball player in North Carolina who received a severe head injury after being hit by a spike from a biological male playing

[00:24:55] on the opposing team? Or the man identifying and playing as a woman who in the very rough and high-contact sport of rugby injured three females during a game? Should we perhaps move on to the hockey game in Middleton, Wisconsin, where a female suffered a concussion after being checked by a substantially larger man, identifying as a woman, and playing on the opposing team.

[00:25:16] As a mother of two daughters, the incidence hits very close to home, and these cases are happening in every sport across the country. In addition to my two girls, I am also the mother of two boys. When considering these policies, we must not forget how these impact our male athletes as well.

[00:25:33] i recently spoke with the richmond area mother whose son is on their high school wrestling team and she said quote the governor's and department of education's new model policies are a welcome relief in many ways girls are participating in wrestling in increasing numbers far worse however is that

girls are going into the locker rooms before during and after practices and matches with the boys and adult male coaches assistant coaches coaches and trainers the extreme discomfort young men having young women present in these intimate spaces must not be discounted boys deserve privacy too it is difficult enough to ask them to compete against a young woman in the most physical

[00:26:13] close contact possible in athletics but then they are forced along with adult male staff into the locker rooms and restrooms with them as well the model policies need to be adopted at every school board level to provide the dignity and respect for all young student athletes by protecting intimate spaces based on their sex end of quote our high school athletes deserve decisions that are based on their safety the governor's model policy does just that and we appreciate the strong stance both the governor's office the board of education and the attorney general's office have taken to enforce

[00:26:47] these policies we urge all counties to adopt and enforce the model policies as presented thank you thank you very much miss amy sneed good morning my name is amy sneed i'm the chapter chair of moms for liberty in bedford county but also the vice chair of our statewide legislative committee while you hear my voice speaking today i'm representing the voices of hundreds of teachers from across virginia who support governor youngkin's new model policy for students teachers whose voices are often drowned out or silenced by organizations who claim to represent

[00:27:27] them but do not i'll be sharing quotes from teachers from across the commonwealth some whose school boards are refusing to comply with the newly instituted model policies who so desperately wish they would. Case in point, a Prince William County teacher recently shared, quote, gender fluid students at the early elementary level in which I teach are an added behavior stress on the teacher and all students. School is first and foremost a place to learn. Our focus as educators needs to be solely on closing gaps and making achievements. We should not be tasked with balancing accepting rules that we the teachers don't fully understand or deem morally acceptable. The governor's policy allows us to do just that. A middle school teacher in Bedford

[00:28:07] county says quote we are grateful for youngkin's policy as teachers we have a lot to do if we can just teach and put it back to the parents we can go home with a sense of peace and normalcy it takes a lot of pressure off of us not having to hide things from parents from an educator in loudon county quote governor youngkin's policies allow for teachers and most importantly parents to be involved in the education and everyday interactions that go on with their child's school day as an educator i enjoy working alongside parents to help bring out the best of their child i don't believe even lying to a child and telling them things that aren't true. I think if a teacher is not allowed to share with parents what's going on with a student in the school, there is a huge

[00:28:44] trust factor that's broken. Another Central Virginia teacher shared, quote, I am personally very thankful that based on Governor Youngkin's model policy, I do not have to go along with pronouns a child may choose, one that goes against the truth of their biological sex. This policy is key to keeping experienced and capable teachers employed in our public schools.

[00:29:03] I can now continue to focus my efforts on what I love, educating and developing future citizens. I also firmly believe that our students, all of them, win with this policy. Whenever adults act like adults and guide children based on truth, children can also rest within proven boundaries and better set their hearts and minds on appropriate learning.

[00:29:23] We can do that now without worrying about compromising our own beliefs or being fired. A Lynchburg City school teacher states, quote, "We are placed in an incredibly uncomfortable situation when a student who is a minor asks us to call them by a certain name or pronouns when they're in school and a different one when we're talking to their parents. It violates my religious beliefs and makes me lie to parents. These are two things that are really upsetting to me and I love that the new model policy removes those challenges for me. The difficulties that teachers and staff experience when their school boards do not adopt the model policy are tremendous because of the wall it builds between parents and staff. We should all agree that the relationship between parents

[00:30:02] and staff should be a bridge, not a wall. Our students, teachers, and staff deserve to be able to focus solely on education. Thank you. Thank you very much. Scott Brabrand, followed by Jawanda Fels. Good morning, everyone. Dear Superintendent Coons and members of the Board of Education, congratulations, Ms. Ashton. My name is Scott Brabrand, and I'm the Executive Director for the Virginia Association of School Superintendents. Bass continues to appreciate the collaboration

[00:30:37] with Dr. Coons and her staff, we do respectfully, respectfully, however, request that you refrain from voting today on any agenda items related to accreditation and accountability that are labeled first and final review. While we've been able to provide general input and ideas on the process this summer with Dr. Coons, this detailed proposal for a new accreditation accountability system and the three big decisions about this system you're being asked to make today were only made available to the public on Monday. There are many organizations and stakeholders that haven't had time to provide input. The public deserves the opportunity to carefully review and provide feedback on this

[00:31:17] significant change to how Virginia evaluates its students and schools. Nevertheless, VAS will offer its initial feedback, subject to the caveat that this new plan should be reviewed by applying our existing data to see how the impact of this new system would differ among our students in our school divisions. We also want to better understand the link to the federal accountability system with this new system and what additional resource supports you all will provide to assist school divisions in implementing the system. So you're being asked to make three decisions today. Here is VAS's initial preference and rationale for each decision. First decision point one on the

[00:31:53] achievement measure index or peer pass rate. Our VAS position is the index, the achievement index. Why? It allows schools to count the achievement of every child, and it also allows teachers to focus on every child in their classroom, not just focusing on those on the bubble for proficiency.

[00:32:14] Decision point two on your readiness indicators. Our vast position there is while we like the readiness indicators across all levels, we would advocate for removing the reading indicator from elementary, and the math indicator from middle, because it's double counting in another category an achievement indicator that already exists somewhere else. For the high school indicators, we like those, but we would advocate that the military readiness indicator would be best under college and career readiness, because it is part of being college and career ready to join

[00:32:48] the United States military. Decision point three is around the accountability rating system and overall or a summative rating for each category in a placemat like uh format our position is a summative rating for each category in that placement level format why it provides transparency for our students and schools better about how they're actually performing and we believe vast ascd has said it's the best

instructional approach we'll send you some additional remarks about low proficiency which is news to superintendents we haven't seen that before

[00:33:26] And we look forward to having many of you at our fall conference next month. Thank you very much. Jawanda Fells, followed by Nancy Smith. Good morning, President Creasy, Vice President Hansen, members of the Virginia Board of Education, and Dr. Coons.

[00:33:56] I am Dr. Jawanda Rollins-Fells, and it is my honor to address you today as a member of the Board of Directors for the Virginia School Board Association. As the board continues to address the Commonwealth's accountability and accreditation system, the SBA respectfully asks this board to continue its tradition of hearing the items before today on first review,

[00:34:20] to allow education stakeholders more time to weigh into the options before the board and provide meaningful feedback on decisions that will have a lasting impact on the Commonwealth School's children, parents, and communities.

[00:34:37] the sba strongly believes in the importance of holding school divisions accountable for the education outcomes of students we support an accountability system that utilizes the standards of learning to measure student achievement with the inclusion of state approved authentic measures of student growth over time our president david woodard delivered these remarks when he addressed the board this past June. I speak today specifically to the agenda item F and the use of a rating or

[00:35:11] summative method to communicate accountability results. Whether it is an A through F, a series of stars, or descriptive labels, the SBA is concerned that unless the rating system is used to drive resources and supports to students and schools in challenging environments, the label will do more harm to schools and increase the likelihood of the school not making needed strides in academic achievement. We're also concerned that the rating system will have serious consequences

[00:35:45] on a school division's ability to recruit effective educators, a negative impact on staff and student morale, and will harm the local community's financial prospects. We ask that the board consider these factors as they weight their decision on communicating accountability results.

[00:36:04] Last week, the General Assembly adopted revisions to the 22-24 biennial budget, investing large sums of money to increase state dollars to fund SOQ-supported positions, staff salary increases, and flexible spending for school divisions to use in combating learning loss and the implementation of the Virginia Literacy Act.

[00:36:25] VSBA thanks the General Assembly for these additional funds and looks forward to working with the Yonkin Administration, the Board of Ed, and the Department of Education to ensure that the academic success of every public school student is achieved. Additionally, we thank the Board of Education and the Department of Education for their collaborative relationship with VSBA.

[00:36:49] we look forward to continuing this discussion as the board advances your work thank you so so much for the opportunity to speak uh nancy smith followed by elena asby good morning good morning my name is nancy smith and i reside in michael county i'm a 32-year veteran educator having worked for a large school division of virginia for the entirety of my career i worked as a teacher a clinical practitioner and a program manager in the field of education

[00:37:26] for deaf and hard of hearing children i work with committed teachers administrators therapists and all of the wonderful wonderful auxiliary staff who keep the buses running the lunch line moving in the buildings clean there have been dramatic changes since my retirement in 2011 and sadly none of them for the better while i could expound on what i believe has happened none of that really matters now it only matters that our schools are turned around and focused on the reasons that they exist to educate our children. I'm grateful to the Youngkin administration for guiding Virginia schools towards a better future. The model policies that have been put forward put the privacy and

[00:38:04] safety of our children back in the hands of parents. I sincerely hope that they lead us back to the common sense that is so desperately needed in our schools and our communities. Those school divisions who have pronounced their plan to defy the governor's policies must be condemned in the strongest terms possible. Schools belong to communities and to families and not to bureaucracies i worked within a bureaucracy i understand how bureaucracies work and it's so important that they are returned to families and children i applaud your efforts and urge you to continue to take a strong stand in the name of thousands of children in virginia

[00:38:39] schools who depend on this administration to make a course correction bring about important change and once again reinstate excellence in virginia schools thank you elena esby followed by melvin Adams. Good morning. My name is Elena Espy. I'm a mother and a candidate for school board in

[00:39:15] Henrico County. First, I would like to congratulate you on delivering stronger math standards. This is how we change the trajectory of math learning and meet the needs of each and every one of our students. Next, thanks to you and the governor for all in Virginia. Combating learning loss resulting from the COVID years is a top priority for me personally. We know that absenteeism has doubled since 2018 and that reading and math scores have plummeted and failed to recover in that same time frame your plan to combat absenteeism and infuse our schools with high quality instructional staff and tutors is going to make a significant difference in our students outcomes i would like

[00:39:51] to address the new model policy on ensuring dignity and respect for all students this is a common sense and practical guide for how to implement the law aside from addressing discrimination and harassment and giving all students an equal opportunity to feel safe in their school environment this is a tremendous step forward in ensuring transparency between students teachers and parents which is a goal of all school personnel parents ptas including myself parental involvement in education is not only a right it's a responsibility and empirical evidence demonstrates parental inclusion in a child's education is the number one predictor of success i have deep concerns however about the implementation we've already heard multiple

[00:40:29] school districts refusing to adopt the policy while others still have yet to acknowledge the policy throughout my campaign i've spoken with hundreds and hundreds of parents no matter what side of the political fence they all have one thing in common and that's that they do not want teachers or administration keeping secrets while i applaud attorney general miara's reiteration of policies the law we as parents lack practical pathways for ensuring our school systems are implementing this policy this phenomenon was evident during efforts to implement covet policies and they continue today suing a school board is simply not a realistic option for most if not all parents it's really a luxury reserve for only the most educated i'm asking you today to consider

[00:41:09] stronger oversight for school boards who do not swiftly implement policies because as long as the policy goes unimplemented the health and safety of our students continues to be at grave risk and while the impact to children is very obvious let's talk about teachers for a moment during my campaign i've also been spending a lot of time with teachers learning more about their motivators and wishes it's clear to me that the administration doesn't comply with laws teachers also suffer they lack direction and often find themselves in crosshairs between parents and administration and unhappy teachers quit so let's not let the problems continue to be exacerbated by political posturing the stakes are too high thank you all for your hard work and let's keep up the

[00:41:47] momentum melvin adams followed by noel pack noel pack good morning my name is melvin adams i'm the founder and president of noel webster educational foundation i'm here to speak on behalf of citizens both parents and educators in the commonwealth i'll speak briefly up to two points and then give some perspective the government first the governor's model policies the feedback we are getting is that a strong majority who are aware of the policies support them especially the focus

[00:42:25] in athletics where participation is to be based on the students sex this policy is reassuring to many concerned parents and students the challenge we're all facing right now is where some districts are refusing to comply. It's unhealthy. It is hard for administrators and teachers to work and for parents and students to have clarity if the model policies are not implemented by their local school boards. We all hope that these matters can be resolved quickly. Second, the new math standards.

[00:42:59] I wish to commend you on developing more vigorous math standards for Virginia schools. Higher expectations lead to higher performance and outcomes, which lead to opportunities and careers for our students and a stronger future for the Commonwealth. Critical fields like engineering and many sciences and technologies are highly dependent on advanced mathematics. These fields impact our prosperity and our national security. The losses we have experienced in recent years have put us in a place of potential jeopardy. We must excel in math. It is our future, along with

[00:43:37] the foundational ability to read, another area that needs critical attention. But thank you for your work and leadership. Third, a little perspective. Boards, administrators, and teachers who stand between students and parents are on the wrong side of history. Many recent surveys indicate this reality across all political parties. Last week, a national survey was done by the Pacific Policy Institute. It shows that voters want school boards to listen to parents and focus on what public schools have historically been tasked to do by raising student achievement in

[00:44:15] math, reading, and other core subjects. When asked why so many voters rated their local school boards unfavorably, and they could select more than one choice. 59% said they are focusing on the wrong goals. 55% said they don't listen enough to parents, and 55% said they are trying to promote an ideology or personal agenda. There are many interesting insights resulting from the survey, but when asked what school boards should do, the top three priorities voters gave as their first

[00:44:49] choice was first, listen to parents, 21%. Second, focus on improving student achievement, 19%. Third, listen to teachers and direct leaders, district leaders, 13%. Communities expect more from their schools. Thank you, sir. Thank you. I'm sorry. Time has expired. Noel Pack, followed by David Rudman. I think I'll need this. Dr. Coons, members of the board, thank you for allowing me the opportunity to be here today.

[00:45:25] My name is Noel Pack with Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. HMH is a trusted partner with the Virginia Department of Education in many school divisions across the state. We provide resources that align the Virginia standards of learning and many services to our partners, including professional development for state initiatives, sponsoring professional conferences and supporting other educational organizations.

[00:45:46] The reason I'm here today is to voice my concern or our concern for the proposed escalated timeline for math textbook adoptions. To be clear, we support the new standards and the focus on high expectations, but we also believe that this Russian submission of materials could have a negative ramifications on the students and teachers of Virginia.

[00:46:05] We respect your decision to move up the timeline if that's what you vote to do today. However, we humbly request that if in fact the decision today is made to move forward with the timeline, that you respectfully keep the bid process window open to encompass the original timeline as well. We know that there may be some misconceptions that the New Virginia Standards are similar to Common Core, so national programs would simply match. However, there are many differences that call for new lessons at every grade level and modifications for assessments

[00:46:40] and differentiation. Let me ask you, don't you want a true Virginia-specific program? The newly proposed timeline will surely limit options and quality. Because we listen to our divisions, we also know that teachers and students value print resources. More time is needed to focus on alignment, accuracy, and make sure that we embed pedagogy that follows the goals of the new standards. Currently, many divisions in Virginia are in the process of evaluating ELA programs due to the Virginia Literacy Act, and our current state contract with math in Virginia

[00:47:16] does not expire until 2025. 95% of all school divisions in Virginia that purchase math curriculum have purchased, have paid subscription contracts that until at least 2025 and beyond. Most divisions will not be purchasing math in 2024. The new timeline is calling for the evaluation, for the evaluation review committee to also take place during the holidays. I just like to point this out because I feel like we're going to miss out on some of your best reviewers because of that commitment. In closing, please remember that the approved standards were released just three weeks

[00:47:56] ago on August 31st. I know you want the best options for teachers and students. Please consider allowing us more time to provide what Virginia teachers and students deserve. Thank you all so much for your time. David Rudman, followed by Catherine Fulton. It's David Rudman here. Catherine

[00:48:22] Fulton. Carol Nice. Good morning. My name is Carol Nice. I'm a parent, grandparent, citizen, and voter in Fairfax County. My engagement with Fairfax Public Schools stretches way back to over 50 years ago when my family moved to Virginia when I was in the fourth grade. My husband is also a graduate of Fairfax County Public Schools, as are four of our six children. So I guess you

[00:49:00] could say that we have some skin in the game. And I've noticed changes through the years, most markedly a dramatic lessening in the time and attention that's spent, I guess, on what I'll call core academic subjects and a much greater focus on what I'll call identity issues. When When the Virginia State Department of Education released the model policies in July, I was hopeful that these policies would kind of lighten the load of the FCPS school board because they would have policies that they could go on and they could renew their focus back to the academic endeavors in the classroom.

[00:49:36] I was encouraged to see that the model policies considered over 70,000 public comments submitted during the comment period, as well as over 9,000 comments submitted in 2021 in preparation for the earlier guidelines. As such, these 2023 guidelines are truly reflective of what the citizens of Virginia would like to see in public schools. However, just a month after the guidelines were issued, the superintendent of Fairfax County Public Schools issued a community letter making it known that fcps would ignore the 2023 policies honestly this didn't come as much as a as much as

[00:50:15] as much as a surprise i've been watching fcps cavalierly ignore many concerns expressed by a majority of parents and citizens for years this brevity of this time period doesn't allow me to go into details but i could suffice it to say fcps's tendency to enshrine the desires of a tiny minority over majority rights continues to be baffling. Anyway, my comments today are to express gratitude to Attorney General Mayaris for his very thorough analysis of the 2023 model policies

[00:50:49] and his conclusion that the policies comply with applicable federal and state civil rights laws, and to express my dismay and disappointment with FCPS and others' disregard for what's truly best in students' and parents' rights. FCPS not only acts as if it's above the law, but by ignoring these model policies has, in effect, deemed itself as a de facto arbiter of issues well beyond their wheelhouse. By willfully hiding important information that could affect a child's physical,

[00:51:26] psychological, and emotional well-being, FCPS is playing a dangerous game. Local school officials are not in the position to act as medical diagnosticians or to take over the natural rights of parents to work with their children on important issues.

[00:51:44] Thank you, we appreciate your comments. So I will go back just quickly since we're at our list, the end of our list. It's Wendy Little here, Candace Lucas, Kathy Halverson, Tammy C.

[00:52:07] How about David Rudman or Catherine Fulton? Okay, is there anyone else in the public this morning that would like to speak before we close the public comment section? Okay, thank you very much.

[00:52:29] All right. Okay, so we will move to our consent agenda this morning. Can I have a motion to approve the items on the consent agenda, please?

[00:52:47] We're moved. Ms. Kilgore? I'm sorry, this is the consent agenda? Yes. Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Mr. Hansen? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye.

[00:53:07] Chair votes aye. Okay. We are moving to item B and that will be Dr. Sorensen. Do we need to have a presentation? good morning Dr Sorensen good morning thank you good morning board members thank you for having

[00:53:43] me um as requested at last month's board meeting uh we thought we would come back and present for the Board members an overview of the state textbook approval process so that we could ask the Board for permission to move forward with the textbook adoption process for mathematics.

[00:54:05] As you remember last month, we thank you again for your approval of the new mathematics standards, but in moving forward, we do need your approval. Looking back at policy and procedure, the Board has to grant us approval to move forward.

[00:54:21] in adopting materials next slide please okay so just walking you through um again won't read the slides to you but um here is the policy in general process but wanted to acquaint everybody in the

room with it starts with the board granting us approval to move forward and that starts today and outlining that the board gives us approval to move forward and then videoe will initiate and invite publishers to submit textbooks for review we will create review committees of 12k educators

[00:54:59] from across the commonwealth and we already have committees forming as we speak and we already have 24 educators that we are working with to do standards implementation and we do have an honorarium that we are offering our educators to work with us on this and our publishers will receive evaluations and can respond to the committee's reviews and recommendations so on and so forth but the code of virginia here is outlined for not only the public but the board members and that will also then allow our school boards and our school divisions to not adopt

[00:55:38] things that are on the list if they don't like the things that we so choose giving our school divisions the autonomy to to do what they need to do in order to have high quality instructional materials in front of their teachers one of the things that we feel is essential in this process we know that our teachers are very overworked we know that our teachers are very stressed we talked about that last time we also know that the research says that our teachers are spending between 12 and 15 hours a week planning getting high quality instructional materials in front of our teachers so that they can plan the very best lessons for our young people aligned to our standards is

[00:56:17] essential. And so escalating the process, accelerating the process so that we can get the very best materials in front of our teachers so that they can get the very best materials in front of our kids is essential. And so again, I thank the board for pushing us to bring this in front of you as soon as possible so that we could ask your permission to engage in the process. And so the next slide that I bring before you is the proposed sample timeline and detailed steps in the process that outlines for you that if the Board of Education were to approve the textbook schedule, here it is outlined for us that if approved today, we would engage immediately in the process.

[00:56:57] We already have heard from educators who want to engage in the process with us, again, from across the Commonwealth. Multiple school divisions reaching out saying, yes, we want to be a part of it. Yes, we want to engage. We want our voices heard.

[00:57:13] We also have heard from but not engaged with, I want to be very clear, multiple textbook vendors saying we are ready to step up, we are ready to do what is right for Virginia, knowing that the standards have changed. And so again, not engaged with any of them, as you know, that would not be a part of the process, but we have had multiple vendors reach out saying that they are excited about our new standards.

[00:57:38] So this is the timeline that we are proposing, and then we would come back before the board in March with recommendations that we would put before you to say, here are the highest quality materials that align with our standards, asking for the board to give us permission to vote on said textbooks.

[00:57:54] And by textbooks, again, we mean electronic materials, supplementary materials, intervention materials, all types of materials that would support our teachers and implementing the new standards. Also, what was given to the board was the timeline, a flowchart, and this is also available for the public to see and was available on the public website.

[00:58:18] And so, without belaboring the point, I will close for questions from the board. Okay. At this time, what I would like to do is, before questions, I'd like to have a motion on the table.

[00:58:36] I'd actually like to have a discussion and not questions, because we did hear this. We did have a conversation about this last month. As part of the discussion, will we have a chance to ask questions? Of Dr. Koons, and she can decide whether or not she'd like Dr. Sorensen to answer them.

[00:58:52] So as part of how we move on here, can I get a motion to waive first review and authorize the department to proceed with the review of the K-12 mathematics textbooks? Second.

[00:59:13] Okay, so we can have discussion now. Would anybody like to make a comment? Questions? I do have a couple of questions, and whether this is for Dr. Combs or Dr. Sorensen or who, we heard from one of our major publishers this morning in public comment that the timeline is too fast and will raise concerns about alignment, accuracy, and quality, and will limit the ability to have this be a true Virginia-aligned textbook round.

[00:59:45] There's also a public comment from a smaller publisher, MathSpace, I believe, echoing those concerns. So my question is, Tupole, what is your response to that? And have we had any assurances from publishers that they can meet this time of month?

[01:00:04] So, yes, while not engaging with publishers, because we cannot do that if we are going to engage in RFP processes, and we have heard from multiple publishers that they are excited to work with Virginia, that they can meet the new Virginia standards, they are excited to customize their materials to the new Virginia standards, and they are very much looking forward to working with Virginia.

[01:00:30] If I may, that doesn't say that they're able to meet our timeline. And we heard from, I think, Hoffman Mountain, I think it's one of our major publishers who told us this morning that they can't. Do you have any response to the concerns? Ms. Holton, I'll answer that. We are not allowed to engage with publishers at this point in time. We are asking the board to let us move forward with the proposed timeline and move forward with that. We cannot engage with publishers before you give us permission to move forward to answer the kinds of questions there are multiple publishers other than holton mifflin and math space we have not heard this concern from the myriad of other

[01:01:06] publishers available in this space at this time what's your response to their concern i mean how you know we haven't heard from the others about the timeline specifically and the two that we've heard from about the time i'm going to repeat what i said we cannot engage with publishers at this point in time because we have not had permission from the board to move forward with that process but that doesn't mean we can't address here the concerns that were raised in public comment today and i guess i'll go to a second question which is have what feedback have we gotten from our local partners school board association and superintendent association specifically about whether this

[01:01:46] timeline is workable we are asking the board to waive the process to start the timeline dr kins i assume i mean yeah we did hear we did hear from two publishers we didn't hear from lots of others which i do i mean if this was obviously a commercial concern for a lot of them they would get to richmond and they would let us know where they'd submit electronic comments i assume this is a word we're not a minor state in the in the in the market and so like the fact they're not here i do think that is is is significant i don't intend no disrespect to the ones who did come but it's two of a large market i just assume i just want to be clear this timeline if it did prove

[01:02:25] unworkable for some reason that if we take this action today you could then we could then address down the road if something that is unforeseen comes up that does not seem like a enormous

foreseen challenge is that accurate as dr sorenson said we have over 24 educators helping us with this process and we are really working shoulder to shoulder with those educators and using their voice and their support if we get into a space where the educators don't feel like there is a marketplace for good materials for the virginia commonwealth and the students that they serve we would definitely come back to the board absolutely dr siebert i appreciate the timeline and i'm just

[01:03:05] trying to figure out where are the actual like hard mile posts in this so for example there's an opportunity for publishers to respond in january what uh then then obviously we receive the first review in february so does that really kind of mean january is the hard stop to have your materials yes so we have actually um on here so the last date we would publish it more concretely as we move through we were waiting to get approval today so for example our internal document that we then will make public for example the last date for publishers to submit is november 22nd right

[01:03:41] before the holidays the last day for review then we would make public once we get the reviews in and those dates would become more concrete so when you say what are the hard deadlines those would become say for example january 2024 evaluation committee meets for consensus reviews with doe so we would say say for example and again this is just an example january 31 right so those dates would become hard milestones that we would set with the committee as to what was doable for them knowing that they are educators in the field and we want to respect what is also doable for them

[01:04:18] Dr. Siebert, we also see that publishers are given the opportunity to respond in January, which allows another opportunity for them to come back and make revisions. And of course, as Mr. Rotherham mentioned, if we're seeing at that point that materials, there's not a threshold in the marketplace for school divisions at that point, of course, we would come back and revise that timeline.

[01:04:41] Thank you for that clarification. So what I think, just checking my understanding here, is that if I'm a publisher and November we're not ready, we could bring a better product back in January based on the opportunity to have a review. And they also have the opportunity, once they get feedback from us, to also revise and review.

[01:05:05] Mr. Rotherham? To clarify, I think that's what the gentleman this morning was asking for is exactly what Dr. Siebert just described, the ability to, that we're going to keep this open. You can also come in. If I heard him correctly, it seemed like that was what we're doing was precisely what he was asking for if we weren't going to accommodate the specific request from this particular vendor.

[01:05:25] By way of discussion, I heard him saying that the timeline is unworkable and we need to make adjustments. And I am not comfortable moving forward with one of our major publishers without having that addressed. It's not that there might not be an answer, but I haven't heard an answer yet. And I'll just say by way of finishing my comments that this is another example of us doing first and final.

[01:05:53] And I understand the reason to do first and final this time, but I will just point out that that means that the public, publishers, et cetera, these matters were posted, I believe, Friday, midday for the public to see. And we have numerous comments that have come in.

[01:06:09] In addition to the publisher, we have a handful of comments, excuse me, that have come in raising this concern, including from some administrators. And I also saw in reviewing the public comments that we had over 200, I think it was, comments come in last month that we never got to see before we made a decision on the mass standards raising issues about the front matter because we're

doing things on such a rushed basis, introducing new material and not giving the public an adequate opportunity to weigh in.

[01:06:37] And it's a concerning pattern. And for all those reasons, I'm not able to vote yes on this today. Any other questions or comments from board members? That's the point of clarification, because the point Ms. Holton raises is important. I think he said, we don't like this timeline, but if you keep it open, if you're going to go with this timeline, keep it open, which is what we're doing.

[01:06:59] If I understood his comments this morning. Dr. Northern. How many, and this is a different comment, how many books are typically made? what's the average of books that are approved on a list typically for for districts to choose from um i would say anywhere from 15 to 40. okay so it's a broad range it's a broad range for them to choose from absolutely and then we also look at various grade bands we look at a k-5 we look

[01:07:35] at a middle school we look at high school and then high school is also by specific course okay thank you it's increasing um ms ashton i am i would be concerned if we do not move forward teachers need materials we just raised the standards um teachers are eager to serve our scholars and if we don't move forward with materials we will be setting teachers up for for failure and so i support moving forward any other questions or comments on this topic just to be clear i'm all for getting started i'm just not uh in favor of getting started on a process that's not realistic and

[01:08:14] hasn't been vetted with our key partners both local partners and and commercial partners anyone else okay all right so we're gonna call for the vote miss kill this this again to reiterate the motion is to waive first review and authorize the department to proceed with the review of k-12 mathematics textbooks miss kilgore how do you vote uh miss holton no dr siebert hi mr hanson

[01:08:49] hi miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr rotherham and chair votes i thank you thank you okay um so item c is mr chapman you have something to present to us just a very quick introduction Thank you, President Greasy, Vice President Hanson, members of the board, Superintendent Kuhns.

[01:09:22] This item is a relatively routine item that comes before the board. This is appointments to the board's advisory committees. As you might recall, the board has six advisory committees that help it with its work. You know, we have a couple of those that are created by statute, the Advisory Board on Teacher Education and Licensure, the Early Childhood Advisory Committee, one that's required by federal legislation are there individuals with disabilities education act which is the state special education advisory committee which you'll hear from later and then in addition the virginia advisory committee for the education of the gifted the adult education literacy advisory committee and the advisory

[01:09:57] committee on for career and technical education back in july of this year the department solicited nominations for for a number of these committees what we have for you to do is today is eight appointments have been vetted by the staff or the advisory board on teacher education and licensure who are named in this board item we are asking that you would wave first review and approve these these nominations so that these members can start on the abtel committee which i believe

[01:10:31] has a meeting coming up later in september okay and so can i get a motion to wave first review and approve the recommended nominees to the advisory board on teacher education and licensure moved okay um any discussion on this item miss kilgore how do you vote ah miss holton aye dr siebert mr hanson hi miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr rotherham hi and chair votes aye

[01:11:06] okay um at this time i'd like to take about a 10 minute break if we could please thank you

[01:24:56] mr chapman are you um are you starting us off on this item or we're on item d yes yes okay so um at this point i'd really like to take a couple minutes to um introduce these next three items and to give you some contacts for members of the public who may not have kept track of this board's special meeting on August the 31st the board as you know many of you have engaged with us on different different elements of this process but you know that we have been talking for quite some time

[01:25:34] about accreditation and accountability for the better part of a year and we've been focusing especially on the complexity and lack of transparency of our current accreditation system the fact that it does not seem to be measuring schools well relative to student performance and its uniqueness relative to those systems in that are used in other states so on august 31st 2023 this board unanimously decided to move forward with the notice of intended regulatory action so that we could finally convert our discussions into action we adopted a broad

[01:26:13] nora as we indicated to staff at our july meetings this is going to be a year-long process that is steeped in opportunities for public comment and stakeholder input but the process had to start somewhere and i think that many of us on the board were kind of tired of talking and ready to to get some action going here and so then the next three items are all important discussion points that we really need to make uh to have in order to direct staff to do the work that we've asked them to do

[01:26:48] Dr. Koons and I have had many discussions about how this work must proceed and without these big picture decisions we cannot move forward. I wanted to say that this all is an introduction to make sure that the public knows how to understand these next three items sort of in the context of how we're going to proceed with these and how they fit into our regulatory work and start setting a stage for additional decisions like these that we will be making over the next few months

[01:27:21] and so um i will now turn over to mr aldman for a presentation thank you madam president it's good to see you all again um got some slides to help frame the conversation today and then we will talk about some options potentially so uh start with some overall guiding principles we've talked about these before like the first principle is uh north star is high expectations for every student we want to have a transparent uh system that provides actionable information for people to act

[01:27:57] on we want to prioritize getting every student to proficiency and mastery we want to make sure we build trust between schools parents and students and we want to have stakeholder input as madam president said we will have a process to include stakeholder input along the way um i want to have a timeline here maybe uh superintendent coons do you want to go through where we've been and where we're going so i think um madam president spoke a little bit about the length of conversation that this board has had around the past accountability and accreditation system and started in october

[01:28:34] with the board having presentations even before i got here about from leading national experts from february to august the board participated in multiple working sessions multiple conversations multiple thought partnership in september 2023 that's today the board will discuss parts of the nora that they asked us to start on in august so moving forward we hope that a lot of the conversation as part of the regulatory process that mr chapman's going to talk through will happen between october and may talking about the board reviewing the results of those public comment and moving

[01:29:12] forward with that regulatory process June through July, and then moving forward with different regulations in 24, 25. And then could you click for me? Yes. That would mean that the data collection would start next year, but the actual process, if moved at a clip and a speed, the fastest the process would start for regulatory action would be a new accountability and accreditation system, accountability system per your conversation last month, August 25 through the 26th school year. So I want to clarify that this has been a process of conversation as Madam

[01:29:50] President spoke to a lot of conversation, a lot of presentations. Over July and August, there are new board members and there was an important opportunity for everyone to get caught up to speed and have conversations and have presentations. In August, you asked us to move forward with the Regulatory process. Today's opportunity is for Chad to continue to clean that up and move forward. And I've asked Mr. Chapman just to step in and remind us of the presentation in July and the length of a Nora and all of the public engagement that goes into that process. So I'm going to turn it over to Mr. Chapman.

[01:30:26] So as you can recall the the where we are right now in this particular actions, this is part of the standard regulatory action. This is the full longest, you know, part of the regulatory development process in Virginia.

[01:30:41] As Dr. Coons mentioned with the board requested of staff on August 31st was that we open up a notice of intended regulatory action. So we've taken that Nora. We have moved that to the Virginia regulatory town hall, and it is currently in the process. And as a reminder that notice of intended regulatory action is exactly what it says.

[01:31:00] It is the notice is the official announcement from this board. In addition to the board meeting to the regulatory world, the regulatory community that the board is about to start an action. And that's what it is. We are about to start an action. We are we are starting an action. Here's what we're doing.

[01:31:16] And that will include its own 30 day public comment period. That period has not started yet. It will be, you know, coming up in the next in the coming weeks once it clears the executive branch review process, the Nora does, and then it will get published in the Virginia Register of Regulations.

[01:31:33] So the public, in addition to, you know, commenting, you know, right now, and these items will have the opportunity to comment very specifically on the Nora that you approved during this public comment period for that stage. There are a lot of other stages to this process, two more to be precise, and the important one, as we discussed during the regulatory training in July, is the proposed stage.

[01:31:57] That is, you know, once the Nora has finished, those public comments have been compiled. We will go into an extensive development period where stakeholders are engaged. in the process of bringing to you, and this will happen normally on two reviews, we will actually bring you the proposed text. So part of that stakeholder development is going to say we're doing a regulatory action, but eventually we have to put it down on paper and let folks know exactly what's going to happen. So the board will have an opportunity to review that. And in addition to the comments you will receive at the board meetings, when those come as items before you,

[01:32:37] there will then be a specific 60-day public comment period on the Virginia Regulatory Town Hall once that you have approved that text. So even that process has a 60-day public comment period. After the proposed stage has closed, the item will then come back to you again for a final stage.

[01:32:55] So board staff, sorry, department staff will compile all the comments that we've received at the proposed stage, anything else that has come into the department in that time, and you will be able to see The text that we approved, how does that line up with the stakeholder input that we received, even before we approved text, and then you will be able to make the decision at that time, whether there are additional changes that you would like to make in order to account for public comment, or whether you think that this text is really ready to move forward as it was approved at the proposed stage.

[01:33:28] Once the final stage makes it and is approved by the board, it then goes back to the Virginia Regulatory Town Hall and will be subject to another 30-day public comment period. So, you know, this is the long process that is, again, steeped in public comment, to use President Creasy's word.

[01:33:45] There's a lot of opportunities for stakeholder involvement. We are right at the beginning of that phase on this particular action. and mr chapman if if you could just remind us about the specifics of that nora that the board did request public hearings to be conducted that's correct so could you please explain that part again just for the public's um uh just to make sure that we're informing the public of that because it may not be specifically spelled out here but we want to make sure that we're bringing that again to the attention of not only this board but also the public thank you president

[01:34:17] Cresci. And as President Cresci mentioned, part of that NOR process, what was approved, was that there would be public hearings following the proposed stage. So in addition to the opportunity for the 60-day public comment period, in a manner similar, I think undecided at this point, probably be proposed as part of the proposed stage when it comes out and comes to you. But in a manner similar to the SOL public hearings, we will have additional opportunities to move around the state in virtual formats and maybe some others, you know, as the idea is where the public will be able to comment specifically on the regulation.

[01:34:47] Can I ask a clarifying question in response to on the topic you just raised? Ms. Holton. Thank you. So thank you, Jim. Can you go back to the slide before the timeline slide? Can you help me understand where in this process you are anticipating?

[01:35:07] We are anticipating the proposed regs being voted on, and then when when that public hearing stage would be? Dr. Cairns? Yeah, I'm fine with Jim answering this question. I do think a lot of that depends on the development process and where it moves forward.

[01:35:26] If the goal is to have these approved in August, then I think we would be looking at the latest to have a proposed stage that's developed sometime between within the first two quarters of next year. So between January and June would be the proposed stage.

[01:35:45] Correct. and then the final stage would be when well again that's largely dependent on the proposed stage and you know the public comment that's received in that time period if it's moving as quick as it can then you know if the board is very comfortable with the product that it has at the proposed stage then you know the board can move right into the into the final stage after the 60 days that's correct public hearings and and of course board meetings because it has to come back before you at a regularly scheduled meeting or we're at a scheduled meeting yeah dr siebert i'm pretty sure of my understanding here i'm going to ask this question to help check it for for everyone else

[01:36:24] involved so those who have examined the materials for today understand that we're looking at option this and option that and options so help if you clarify for for the public um obviously we have to

have a reasonable amount of specificity to move forward with the proposed stage but that some of of these options were not exclusive points at this point in time? I'm happy to answer that. I think these are, and what Chad is going to present today, and what Chad, Katie, Shelly, and the team have worked very hard to do and appreciate the hard work, is to continue to take the conversations

[01:37:00] from the board each month and put them into discussion slides from following conversations. So last month, you gave us clear discussion and decisions for us to have more conversation, And the board has been wonderful at asking us to bring continued points, continued presentations, such as Dr. Armstrong's presentation and Dr. Solari's presentation to continue to inform this board as you make your conversations more concrete.

[01:37:29] We've been asked to bring more options for the board and those options for discussion and model are what is in front of you with Chad's presentation today. Please. Thank you, Sir Rickins. I think that we have had to move to a number of topics, so that's where the first and final review conversations have happened at different meetings. But the piece of mind I've been trying to share with individuals in the field is at this juncture, because we have this really 18-month process ahead of us, nothing that we're doing today is exclusive of the good ideas that come in the months ahead.

[01:38:03] You and I have had similar field conversations recently and have said the same thing, that the importance of today is to move this conversation from just the board and move it into the regulatory process that has been established by our governing bodies to make sure that we are having plenty of conversation in the field and to move it more into formal conversation and have extensive opportunity for the field to speak.

[01:38:28] Thank you. Thank you, Mr. Chapman. Great. So, excuse me. It's my job to keep facilitating the conversation on substance to keep us moving forward. If you have any process questions, I would defer them to Superintendent Coons or Jen.

[01:38:49] All right. So, let's start just a quick overview of the current accreditation system. It is a, what I would call a rules-based system. So, performance levels are assigned to each of the indicators, and a school can get a level one, a level two, or a level three.

[01:39:06] And then the accreditation status flows from those indicators in those levels. And so theoretically, any school could be identified if it was particularly low performing on any one indicator. We've had a lot of this right now with chronic absenteeism with state, and so there's a lot of concern that chronic absenteeism could suddenly trigger a lot of schools being identified.

[01:39:28] That's what I would call the rules-based system that the current accreditation system uses. We're going to talk today about a different type of system, an index-based system or a mosaic that we've had the term last time that is more of a weighting-based system. So one indicator wouldn't necessarily drive a school's ultimate rating.

[01:39:47] There could be sort of a balanced approach across different performance indicators. The other thing to start out as a framing context is that Virginia's accreditation system has a summative rating. going to use this term a few times today summative i think has a connotation in the field but virginia has a a summative rating it's just called accreditation so right now uh 90 of schools are accredited and uh 10 of schools are accredited with conditions that is a summative rating the law actually requires virginia to have some sort of final determination um we're going to talk about

[01:40:23] what that could look like today um in in the way that schools are evaluated all right so last time we talked about the indicators. We're going to keep diving in on some of the indicators today. We're going to dive in first on the achievement indicator. This is the performance of how students are doing. We talked about two different approaches last time and we narrowed in on two approaches.

[01:40:49] The first one I'm going to talk about is what's called an achievement index. So this is an example from Ohio. We talked about this last time. I'm going to bring it back because we have some data to show you about the sort of impacts of using accountability index achievement index just to go briefly into how that works Ohio has performance bands and they give different weights based on where students are in the performance band and they give smaller increases from students who aren't tested at all if they go to limited or basic they get 0.3 more points if they jump up to proficient they get 0.4 extra points and then there's a small extra bonus if students go into

[01:41:28] the accomplished advanced or advanced plus performance bands uh the one thing i'll note is that virginia has fewer performance bands than ohio so just keep that in mind when we're talking about applying this sort of system to virginia we probably want to use fewer bands but it's uh just to give some example of how it works uh the other thing make i'll make a fine point here is that um the tests not taken uh Ohio gives that a zero and that's going to have some important implications for what's happening for the results so they give some credit just for students who take even if

[01:42:04] they score the lowest level they give some credit for that to sort of encourage participation among all kids all right so these are the results of Ohio it's a scatter plot that shows on the x-axis is the index points that a school earns based on the index I just showed you and the y-axis is the percent proficient. And if you look at these two lines, they're very highly correlated.

[01:42:30] The correlation is above 0.99. So they're very closely related. There are a couple differences between them. The main outliers are schools with very low participation rates. So if you look at some of the schools that I've circled in red there, the difference is schools that did not test uh large portions of their kids uh once schools that did test they started to fall more in line with others but if they did not test them some of those had you know 35 non-participation rates which are some of the ones at the far left the outliers there um the other implication here is

[01:43:08] that two schools could theoretically look different on proficiency rate but still look similar on the index um so what could an achievement index look like for virginia these are hypothetical theoretical weights these are not anything that we're proposing as final weights to talk through but just to show you what they could look like example one would be sort of an achievement weighted indicator index that gives 0.5 for students who reach basic one for students who reach proficiency and 1.5 for

[01:43:41] students who reach advanced if you think about schools and students in the school you can see of how we relate and this school on the left would get 75 points on that index if they did a participation weighted index where you gave some credit for students who at least tested into below basic the right example gives something more like what that could look like the other alternatives that we talked about so in addition to an index we could have a pure

[01:44:16] proficiency metric so this is what it would look like for a school that we evaluated based purely on proficiency you'd get no credit for students who weren't tested you'll get no credit for students who are below basic or basic and you've got the same credit for students who are proficient or advanced and uh this one would get 50 out of this 50 of the students are proficient or advanced in this school all right so that

is the end of this discussion of uh the two types of ways of measuring achievement so chad before we go to the next segment is there a natural stop here that we can

[01:44:54] have questions yeah absolutely good if do you want to finish talking about this slide or do you want to uh no i mean this is sort of the options that we have heard from you all if you wanted to hear more about so we're bringing them back to you uh we would like some guidance from you all about which of these two approaches you prefer if you pick the index approach we'd love to hear more about what sort of preferences you have on waiting or other other sort of guidance you would have for the department as they think through how to structure a treatment index so are there questions

[01:45:27] or comments from the board here at this point dr siebert if you could go back to the index slide for a minute um um this one no our hours the hypothetical yeah again thank you qualified this is the nascent stage and you know nothing is crystallized and we're just thinking about big ideas um as i was driving home from our special meeting in august thinking about this um where i'm interested where my colleagues are on this because i where i think we are like to kind of triangulate that was that we did like the approach of encouraging the assessment of every child and

[01:46:02] engagement and trying to really uh so i i i thought we were kind of moving toward some of the models we looked at i thought overweighted advanced so whether that still is overweighting advanced i don't know because we don't want advanced to mask uh children who are not achieving but i i like the i like the idea that that model incentivizes high achieving students it also looks at where you know getting all kids tested and and seeing where they are so that's i i like this idea because i thought it resonated the other thing i want to double check with folks who served on the 585 work group is that you know this kind of this model this hypothetical is based on using advanced proficient

[01:46:42] basic and below basic which i think there was a lot of resonated uh i think we'll see indicated in the forthcoming report so i i think this is a pretty good concept at that point but i specifically i'm interested madam president and what my colleagues think about the the weighted index versus pure achievement dr north i mean i think we've talked at length that a um an index as we know gives um you know weight and validity and we're looking at the progress of each and every

[01:47:19] child we're incentivizing school systems to you know not just look at the bubble kids not just look at the kids who are struggling to look at kids all along the academic distribution and i think that matters to parents i feel like a long time parents have said you know you know my kids already you know he goes in you know doing pretty well and so you know he doesn't get as much attention to here as some of the other kids or whatnot and so i feel like we're with when we're looking at an index model we're actually saying to parents and families that every child really does matter and every child is in every district is going to be incentivized to make sure that your

[01:47:58] child if they come in and in advance they're going to be in consent advice to try to get them to more than advanced or if they're going to come in at the proficient they're going to be incentivized to get them above that so i think it's a powerful incentive um not only for um schools and school administrators but for families to say like your child matters you know your child matters no matter where they come in we're going to try to um make sure that they grow this school year so um i'm a firm uh proponent of the uh of the index other comments mr rotherham so i like the index um i

[01:48:36] think we should wait participation i mean back in the really bad old days there was that you'd see things happen like like some kids would just always seem to have a field trip on uh the day the day of

assessments um and so there was like some some pretty bad behavior and i think we've moved way beyond that and and the culture is much is much better um and so you want to there's an understanding we need to assess every kid i think you want to give um credit for that i do worry i just want to name we can overweight participation as well and i think in some things we have like for a while we had a graduation rate index that overweighted um how we consider ged's based on

[01:49:14] the data on like the the value of a ged credential relative to other credentials that's because we looked at this and people like whoa that's going to make a lot of schools maybe not look as good as they as they might look and so um i just i i just want to name like we can overdo it on participation um we can also as as dr siebert said if we're not careful we can mask achievement otherwise i worry i mean i think we want to give credit for advanced but we also don't want that able to mask big equity problems um and so we just get all this right and and the slide that i actually think is the most important is your earlier one um like we just have to gut check

[01:49:50] ourselves now going all the way back to the current soa any i mean that is what things look like with like 40 of our eighth graders below basic on NAEP with these really staggering drops we saw in uh over the last few years starting pre-pandemic but then really accelerating during the pandemic that is going to change if we do our job in any sort of a meaningful way and i think it's just really important that we are prepared for that because that's where i worry on the it's like oh we should give a little more credit for participation a little more credit for participation and then suddenly, you know, this doesn't look because we don't want, and it's going to be a

[01:50:29] shock to the system, and we need to manage that if we're going to actually, you know, really be honest about where we are, and I think, so the participation thing is a place, I think, we need to be very sensitive to that, and that's why I wanted to, that's why I wanted to call that out here.

[01:50:48] Ms. Ashton? Sure, if you can go back to the index slide as well. Yeah, I also am very much strongly in favor of the index, particularly the including the below basic, particularly because it does give, I think, teachers and leaders the tools to see like where our kids are right now, but then put plans in place for the next year to provide the appropriate interventions and support because not all kids will need the same things to move to the next level.

[01:51:21] And something else to just consider based on the participation, I think this should not be in the index and should not be as an indicator, is really setting a target around like 95% of our scholars must take the exam. And for my school, that's what we shoot for.

[01:51:39] And if you don't meet it, there's a warning, it's a reminder, but there's no penalty to it. It's just, as a leader, I'm thinking, okay, 95% have to show up for the test, which means 95% have to show up every day leading up to the test to make sure that they are able to grow on the exam.

[01:51:57] So, I wouldn't add that to the indicator, but as a benchmark for leaders to say, it's connected to attendance. So, thank you. Lisa Chavez: Alton, so I concur with my colleagues in support of a weighted index approach, I would suggest that we have not historically had a big problem in Virginia with so well participation rates, I mean mandated and.

[01:52:26] Lisa Chavez: we've been pretty effective in succeeding in getting participation, I would be inclined to wait participation below basic less than point to five and I would be inclined to wait, and this is just as a starting point right. Because I think we are all very clear. Frankly, the agenda items of first and

final today is a misnomer, and I think that's worth making sure the record reflects that that's a misnomer so that the public understands we're really at the beginning of a process of developing proposed regs, as Jim set out.

[01:53:01] But I would suggest that we start a version that would have maybe something lower than 0.25 for below basic, because we don't have a huge participation problem here. And that for basic, I see Ohio rates of basic at 0.6. And I think it would be appropriate to weight the basic a little higher. That would be my, for what it's worth, my inclination for where I would start.

[01:53:24] We did say last month that we would like to see how this whatever we come up with applies to some Virginia data because we want to see does it meaningfully differentiate that's to me one of the key roles of an accountability model is does it drive improvements and it can't drive improvements if it doesn't meaningfully differentiate so I'd like to see it run on Virginia data.

[01:53:49] Dr. Hoons, Chad, you just mentioned earlier that there's a little bit difference in the performance level. So basic is, is that the lowest level? Is that equal to basic in Virginia? Or is that different? The 0.6? I don't know enough about Ohio's assessment bans to say.

[01:54:07] But they have a lower category? They have a lower category. Okay. Well, I think looking at their chart, sorry, looking at their chart, I think their limited is essentially their participation category. But it all, but I guess one point that that makes is that one of the reasons it's so important that we all understand this isn't final is every piece fits into the whole.

[01:54:29] And until we know what we're doing with our testing, our assessment system, you know, we really can't, these, this weighting system has no relevance except in the context of tests that have cut scores, et cetera, et cetera.

[01:54:48] So all of the numbers are all hypothetical until it's part of a whole. I would just say to follow up on that comment, our decision point today has nothing to do with these numbers actually look like, right?

[01:55:06] The decision point is simply about whether we're using this type of index to assign ratings for achievement. And so that's what I think is important here for us to be very clear about.

[01:55:23] These numbers, they're not where we're landing. It is just about having the opportunity to move forward. And I would say, additionally, if you note each of our items here on our agenda are taken up separately, we are going to be discussing these points separately in the public.

[01:55:45] So these are very specific points that we are saying, public we want input on this um and each one of these decision points not just as the whole enchilada the each one of these decision points we want our feedback on Mr. Rotherham I know you had a comment I have more I have actually a question from my colleague um but I'll I also do have a con I think I agree it's a whole system this thing's like a three-legged stool when you think about your standards your assessments your cut scores and we tend to not cut scores tend to one that nobody pays attention to there's rarely anybody in the audience when when that stuff goes on um and everybody's standards you know we get hours on that and they're all actually equally

[01:56:25] important so i agree with miss holton i do think we can come up with an accountability system and then thoughtfully back in because the assessments that stuff will change i think that's doable my question though um i just want to make sure i understood would it be with your comment on below basic and you want to weight that less and then weight basic more like what are you trying to what's the with

with the caveat from our president that we're not doing this but just as we're talking about conceptually what's the behavior you're trying to incentivize i want to make sure i understood what was behind that just that i i think that the below basic i understand trying to incentivize participation but frankly i think we don't have a problem with participation so i

[01:57:04] wouldn't want to give too much weight i mean below basic folks are people who show up and take the test and get all the answers wrong potentially so i wouldn't want to give too much weight to that that would be where I would start. And I hear you, we're not being asked to make a decision on it at this point.

[01:57:21] I'm just offering that by way of feedback as the department works on a proposed first draft, I offer that for consideration. And then I would suggest that I think basic, getting all students to a basic proficiency level is incredibly important.

[01:57:38] And I would therefore rate that a little higher as does Ohio. - And Madam President, could we, for the record, could we get i have absolutely no idea on the participation data and i think as part of this that would be really useful so dr coons could we uh for the record request we actually get and obviously like the last couple of years it we would not want to wait yeah but like so sort of pre pre-pandemic and then these most recent years we can make some inferences about that would be really helpful well and i certainly think that whatever we do fall on uh does not um we don't

[01:58:10] want to reflect any incentive to not test so yeah um miss ashton and then dr siebert thank you i i think we're conflating two different things i i am not assuming that if a student who hasn't been there um and then shows up for testing is going to get a below basic in fact i have students who have chronic absenteeism and actually because they're they are really thoughtful and smart do very well because they do they have great test taking strategies not saying that's all kids but

[01:58:45] i'm not making that assumption i'm i'm making the assumption that if a scholar if a scholar is below basic that means they have not mastered the material and this is data that i need to know in to in order to improve the attendance point that i was making was really around making sure that we have incentives for participation in the test but i think to the point we need the data around where our participation is in order to make sure it's accurate so i just don't want to conflate attendance means you know just show up for the test and bomb it and therefore the data is

[01:59:23] skewed so um this might be a present this might be something for superintendent coons to ask her accountability and i'm sorry her uh policy team to look into my understanding is the code virginia gives parents the opportunity to opt their children out and as long as parents have the opportunity to opt their children out um we're going to need to be mindful of that we're going to hear about that from the field in terms of how that in fact impacts this process because even you know in a small division you with a small school you just need a few parents hanging out the pool over the summer saying hey we're not going to have our kids test this year and and have an impact so So it's just something we need to be mindful of as we go along.

[02:00:02] Well, and perhaps if that data point is anything significant, then that should be noted in a different way as well. So opt-out might be different than that test. Correct. Dr. Northern?

[02:00:18] Yeah, I'm thinking the same thing. I mean, I don't like the idea of conflating participation in a test with achievement levels. Like, these are apples and oranges here. And so I think we need to be

accounting for participation in a different way, but not mesh it in with an achievement index. It's not about achievement if you don't show up for the test.

[02:00:39] And the other thing I would say is, I don't know, I'm kind of favoring a five point scale just because I think proficient is where we're aiming right and then I think we should have two above it and two below it. below it. I mean, a Likert scale is very common, a five-point Likert scale. We're all familiar with those. I think if we take off the test not taken, which really shouldn't be in here anyway, then we have a nice, clean five-point Likert scale with proficient, which is the goal.

[02:01:08] And then we have advanced, advanced plus above that. And then we have basic and limited below proficient. So it actually gives us even more, I think, granularity in terms of how kids are doing. And so I don't know. I feel like if we, again, separate out the participation, I typically prefer a five-point index for the granularity it provides and the additional incentives it gives to school districts because it gives them another lever to show that we're adding value and growth.

[02:01:37] Mr. Rotherham? So, okay, I'm loathe to criticize Ohio because I have to sleep on the couch because my wife is a proud daughter of Columbus. I'm also loathe to disagree with with Amber Northern. I've learned that the hard way, but I do disagree.

[02:01:55] I just think we we need to keep obviously too few categories. It compresses, and it doesn't you you have kids within those categories who are actually very different, and so it doesn't meaningfully differentiate. That's a problem, but too many and we're seeing some other states do this.

[02:02:10] California is going through this like in a very visible way. not giving away any state secrets it becomes indecipherable for parents it becomes indecipherable for educators for stakeholders so i i think like i i think this is too many and i think we need to figure out like i do think the nape sort of you know you're below basic basic proficient advance isn't a bad model we don't necessarily have to go with that but i think five is is a lot and more than that um people want to know like what is what does it mean i worry you get to a place where people think oh my kids passing or whatever term we use that's good and they don't realize that's actually not a standard that's got you on track for post-secondary for instance or things like that

[02:02:49] so i think i i want us to be really sensitive um uh to to the fact that we're building we're building a system that needs to communicate to multiple stakeholders in the in an effective way

[02:03:02] Ms. Ashton, go ahead. I was just going to say, which I mean, given our heavy emphasis on transparency in this whole process, I think it would behoove us to have pretty significant definitions of what each one of those categories means so that parents are very clear about and schools are very clear about what each of those terminologies that we have in these types here actually speaks to.

[02:03:32] and and you know obviously we we want to make it positive right how do we then move our our students from one particular category into the next and so um i just wanted to make sure that we include some kind of definition there thank you i i would just add that um i think we are agreeing with the index and getting into the specifics will be helpful as we go through the process and we engage with key stakeholders i think one thing that i would like um some feedback on as we go through the process is what have how how have states done the implementations

[02:04:12] for example i'm in a state where we we started with a three error and now we're moving to a five and that that makes sense because we've had some experience with the stars etc and you know i think

we want to lead in Virginia and so the question is how do we lead in a way that makes sense that meets us where we are and just the reality of a shift to a system like this there's just going to be some brutal facts that are going to come out and we're going to have to be prepared for it we're going to have to be prepared to see that we're all not the same and the data doesn't look

[02:04:47] good but really it's the implementation and I heard this earlier from the comments it's about the resources that are going to be provided the training that's going to be provided so i think just getting more examples of implementation um particularly when you're first starting a system like this i think will be helpful for us as well as for the public in terms of what to expect but also what to prepare for any other comments thank you can move ahead do we need to have an official

[02:05:23] discussion on there to vote on this or yes um so what i would like to do is take up item d at this point so after this particular presentation after the presentation at the special meeting and these conversations today my impression is the board is leaning towards adopting that um this performance index so again sans numbers um can i get a motion to waive first review and move forward with the performance index model as the new achievement indicator in the revised accountability system

[02:06:03] second but with i have an amendment as well hang on okay um so we have a uh motion and a second and now we will take discussion i just think the wording needs to be careful because what the motion i heard you say made it sound like a decision and i think that this is an indication of our initial preference rather than a decision i don't think it's appropriate for us to make a decision until we're in the regulatory process that was going to be my friendly amendment i think it needs the word development in there that we're we're moving forward to develop it

[02:06:38] um was the word i thought was the word i thought was was missing in the uh so to develop can you read the motion yes i will okay so um we would um the the motion would be to waive first review and move forward with move forward to develop a performance index model as the new achievement indicator in the revised accountability system comments can we add in the proposed revised

[02:07:14] accountability system so it clearly references we're talking about what's going into the proposed what we're heading towards the proposed regs stage may i make that friendly amendment to the friendly the amendment. Sure. Okay. So let me read the motion again. The motion will be to waive first review and move forward to develop a performance index model as the new achievement indicator in the proposed revised accountability system. Everybody okay with that? All right. Does anybody

[02:07:51] need to discuss that? Ms. Kilgore, how do you vote? Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Ashton. Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye. Mr. Rotherham. Aye. And chair votes, aye.

[02:08:13] Great. Career readiness. Yeah, we're going to move on into readiness indicators. So at the last board meeting, we talked about growth. We don't have any updates on that today, but we are going to talk through some of the readiness indicators that could go into the revised accountability system. And we're going to talk about them at different levels. So we're going talk about elementary, middle, and high school readiness indicators. The first discussion is on elementary school readiness indicators. So we have tried to coin catchy names for them. We've called it ready to learn and ready to read. The ready to learn would be very similar to what we've used in

[02:08:51] the past of consistent attendance, chronic absenteeism defined as the percentage of students who are absent for 10% or more of the school year. The ready to read indicator would be essentially a third

grade literacy metric. It would essentially double count students in third grade to look at the percentage of students reading proficiently proficiently in third grade to make sure that they were ready to to read and doing well and decoding and being able to interpret text. There's evidence that third grade is a significant indicator of whether students actually read

[02:09:31] third grade is indicative of whether they're going to be successful in later life. So there's some research suggesting that. Before we move on to the other grades, I'm going to suggest that we pause on and talk about elementary before we go to the other grade levels. I also want to remind us of the conversation with Dr. Solari yesterday. One of the reasons we had Dr. Solari come and Chad was not able to be here, but one of the things Dr. Solari talked about was a lot of the early literacy and the formative and the importance of forming teachers' decisions.

[02:09:59] She just want to remind us of that conversation yesterday around the formative years in literacy. I have a question. Ms. Holtan. You don't need to go back on the slides, but going back to our discussion about the proficiency index, I'm realizing one thing I'm not sure I understand about Ohio or about where we're heading. I was assuming we're going to have a proficiency index for literacy and a proficiency index for math and history and science as we do under our current system, that we're not going to just collapse all those into one. Is that

[02:10:38] correct? Yeah, we're going to talk about, in the third part of the conversation, we're going to talk about weighting, and I can talk more about what metrics would go into those. But yes, there would be math and reading would be part of that. So this ready, these indicators would be separate in addition so they would be readiness indicators built so then my question is if there's going to be a literacy performance index for third grade that is basically a sum summation of third fourth and fifth grade how different how is a ready to read third grade literacy really going to add

[02:11:15] something different from that proficiency indexing or is it just going to unnecessarily complicate matters counts and complicates what uh is on the table here is essentially double counting so double counting third grade proficiency whereas the uh reading achievement indicator will count third fourth fifth and sixth for grades that have them and it'll uh include them as all so it won't be a separate third grade indicator this would be a separate third grade indicator i'm assuming that most of our most of our elementary schools stop at fifth so mostly

[02:11:51] elementary school literacy third fourth and fifth if we wanted to put extra weight on literacy would another way to do it be just to somehow in our summative literacy somehow wait third grade a little more i just think that you know i i think we're are we unnecessarily double counting and complicating you know if well um i'm gonna let that may be more common than question i get it i think double counting implies multiplying something by two and i don't think that's what when we when we haven't determined the ratings the scales the index i think we have plenty of time

[02:12:27] so i i you know kind of like your comments last month miss holton involved the idea of the virgin literacy act and what the early grades were going to do and that readiness so the idea that we're looking at for ready to read at third grade raising that bar but not actually doubling i think its impact in terms of the over system i again first blush lots of time to listen to colleagues and whatnot i think uh i i like this because it does i think value what we're doing with the system formerly known as pals and and and moving forward toward that that third grade

[02:13:03] reading i also think it's way better to do it this way than you know some failed options options in other states where it's just like oh we're going to make children not be promoted or move you know We got to keep children growing and learning. So this resonates with me at this point. Dr. Ashton.

[02:13:21] I'd like to be a doctor, but I'm not. Sorry. So the way I was thinking about this, but this is where I need to correct me if I'm wrong. It's like the performance index is like the actual scoreboard at a football game.

[02:13:38] The readiness indicators are the stats of the players leading towards the ultimate score. Is that right? Or am I not thinking about it? Well, we're jumping ahead a little bit to sort of the how we balance different indicators. I think of them more as like if your child has a GPA, for example, the GPA would be the overall what they got, then the subject scores would be that. So readiness would be one component of what adds up to something potentially, which we're going to have that discussion as well.

[02:14:12] but uh so this is this would be how we think about the readiness indicator in addition to the achievement indicator and the growth indicator got it okay i get it miss holton oh i'm sorry dr northam northern why do i say that so just to clarify we're not using the new vowels what was pals data because that's a formative assessment that's not what we're proposing here correct no okay and my other um just to put it on the table ohio yes i know it

[02:14:45] best because I've worked in that state. Their third grade measure here is just on the reading portion of the exam. So depending on how we structure our new assessment, there could be, I mean, there's lots when you're looking at a, you know, an ELA exam, you've got, you know, you're assessing different components, right, of literacy, and we can have just a reading portion of the exam that, so we're not double counting. So just the reading portion would be counted here, which is, again,

[02:15:16] another state does it so just by way of discussion by way of discussion i'm not yet uh convinced that we need more indicators and it may come back to how um how all the pieces come together in a whole if one for instance were to simply add this indicator into our current structure it's basically one more way to fail one of the crucial facts about our current structure it is a mosaic or or

[02:15:49] placemat system except it's one where failure on any one motile means failure on the whole so if you are not at level one contrary to that first slide there are lots of schools that are fully accredited but still have extra oversight obligations because they're in level two on one indicator if you're in level two on one of the key indicators then you have extra review extra engagement with the department etc but leaving that aside if if

[02:16:23] we were to simply add an extra indicator into our current system it's both extra adds extra complexity and adds one more way to flunk schools essentially without adding particular value so i say that just to say this all depends on what's the ultimate picture is going to look like um if if we're going to have an ultimate picture as you suggest that is more uh balancing in whether in a mosaic or a summative rating style then it's not such a big deal to add one more indicator but even then

[02:17:01] i don't completely understand what what value does it add if it duplicates and i don't mean that as a question i mean that more it's just a comment i mean i don't i don't i don't have any objection to it i'm just not yet convinced that it makes sense to the whole so i guess maybe one way to think about it is we could ask the department to include it in consideration of it in proposals so that we can keep it on the table

as we put the whole together. But I wouldn't want to commit to it yet. Yes, would be where my inclination. That's where I am. I'm not ready

[02:17:39] to commit to it, but we're being told we're not being asked to commit to anything yet. So maybe it's just whether we want it further developed. Any further comments here? We can go to the other grade bands and then we can circle back if people have other comments so um the next grade band is middle school readiness and uh to miss holton's point we would figure out a definition for elementary and middle that made sense uh we do that already so we would figure out how to do that and apply it fairly to all divisions um so what's on the table here are um two different

[02:18:14] options and there's two options within the second one so just like in elementary school we would have ready to learn would be the same definition of chronic absenteeism and attendance um the second one is a focus on math so just like in the earlier in the early grades uh the proposal on the table is to have a special focus on literacy in the middle grades a special focus on math but we have two different ways to consider that so uh 2a what we're calling 2a is essentially looking at the The percentage of students who take and succeed at an end-of-course math exam.

[02:18:51] So it's not just pushing kids to take it, but it would actually only give credit if they succeeded in an end-of-course math exam by the end of eighth grade. Option 2B is essentially more similar to the literacy, the early reading thing.

[02:19:09] This is more do students meet proficiency by the end of eighth grade. William Boschelli: And this would be on the grade level the eighth grade sol test so essentially more of a gateway into are they ready for high school level math so the option two way is more about rigor option to be is more about a gateway for readiness for high school level math i'm happy to take any questions or comments on.

[02:19:42] So the first thing, and I forgot to raise this in the elementary, but you've got this chronic absenteeism thing up there. Our current system has chronic absenteeism independent of readiness indicators. And I think it's a valuable indicator. And we've had some discussion around this board on it back in the spring. Maybe there's an appetite for no longer waiting, using a chronic absenteeism indicator. I haven't heard it.

[02:20:11] So my suggestion would be we assume that whatever system we have is going to that we work towards developing a proposed reg that it keeps chronic absenteeism as one of our indicators independently of whether it is the readiness indicator.

[02:20:28] I think it's, I consider that's a separate category from a readiness indicator. And as to the other options, it just, to me, suggests that, I think that the, you know, whether you've taken algebra and passed an exam, that actually does add different information from the test.

[02:20:48] On the other hand, I guess that then puts more than the classroom teachers have two points of stress and pressure every spring. But I do think that that one is one that adds some extra information that the other option to be wouldn't and that that is correlated to in research to success, student success.

[02:21:16] Dr. Siebert. So, I think that part of your concern might be addressed when we decide what's on the placemat and whether it's a separate place setting or, I don't know, I'm going to mess up all kinds of metaphors here. So, yes, I definitely, what I do appreciate is chronic absenteeism in the current rules-based system can be the one gotcha.

[02:21:36] The fact that we're moving toward it being reported and considered with all things to be determined alike. My caveat here, putting on my middle school hat, which is kind of old and dated, would be that I've always been passionate about young people taking advanced math courses as soon as they're ready.

[02:21:53] If they want to try it, give it a shot. And so even one of my own children, you know, was able to go through an appeal process to get around a prerequisite to challenge himself in mathematics in middle school. And it worked. It was great. However, I think there needs to be a caveat because we don't want to also double test kids.

[02:22:10] So a child who tries and goes after geometry or algebra one, it doesn't get the passing score, probably is not taking the math eight SOL test. And so that means that, but they probably would pass it. So I just think there's going, we're going to need to give a little consideration that if we're going to encourage children taking advanced coursework, that we don't disadvantage the fact that they reached high and want to miss it by a little bit when they absolutely could nail that math eight SOL.

[02:22:39] well. It's not duplicative. Dr. Northern. I would just encourage us, and I brought this up at the last meeting as a part of our development process, to also look at a different measure of attendance, which would be, again, attendance value added. So chronic absenteeism is directly correlated to the poverty level and the SCS at the school. We know that. It doesn't mean it's not important because it means all kids need to be coming to school. So it's an important measure. But it also doesn't take into consideration the efforts a school may be doing, you know, knocking on doors,

[02:23:19] having pizza parties, whatever. And it shows whether that school is adding growth to that attendance in addition to the chronic absenteeism measure. It's not, you know, it's not been in use by a lot of states yet. We're just still kind of piloting it. But I would encourage us to look into that as a potential type, another type of attendance, not to substitute. I know people get upset when, you know, we talk about taking chronic absenteeism away. It's not. It's just potentially thinking about a different way of measuring that as well and just to be able to

[02:23:56] discuss that. So I think my only concern with that that I'd push back on a little bit is just a lack of transparency. So when we're trying to be as clear as possible about, you know, what these indicators truly represent, I worry that we would cloud it more, because at the end of the day, every teacher knows that when a child is not present, they are not ready to learn. And so, you know, that's efforts. I know there are plenty of school divisions that are doing

[02:24:28] unbelievable things in getting students into classrooms, but it is a problem. It really is a problem. And I think that it's very important for us to be extremely open to discussing that very specific data point and how it's affecting student achievement, how it is affecting student growth. So I feel it being separate remains to be an important part of this conversation.

[02:25:01] And just to clarify, I'm not arguing to be separate. I'm just arguing that right now under under a chronic absenteeism measure, schools that tend to be low performing and serve disadvantaged kids tend to, it tends to be correlated to a chronic absenteeism measure. Schools that tend to serve wealthier kids, better neighborhoods tend to get, to score higher on that measure. It has nothing to do with the efforts that they're, that they're making. So some, some schools are getting unfairly penalized for chronic absenteeism measure, while other schools are getting credit for doing nothing so i'm only saying and you're right it's definitely would be more complicated but i think

[02:25:40] you know it would also be a little bit more fair if paired we have proficiency and growth in achievement we have growth in chronic absenteeism with attendance um i don't know maybe that's too much for people to wrap their head around um but i'm just simply um just saying like we're always talking about new measures like nationally and we're and we have a dearth of of measures beyond reading math proficiency and the more new measures that have been validated and tested and reliable um that's that's not a bad thing so actually so the challenge would to be um incentivizing the behavior you want properly

[02:26:20] and also simple and transparent is just a real challenge and but i would just like to point out that our current system it's using as it may be does give some weight to growth on chronic absenteeism not to an individual student growth but to the school growth so if the school you can you can be level one on chronic absenteeism by being above the cutoff score for chronic absenteeism or you can be level one if i'm correct about this by being within us but a band below that but moving towards level one and then likewise from level three to level two if you are below a certain

[02:26:59] score but we have progressed from one year to the next on your school chronic absenteeism rate so there is a school progress factor not an individual student growth factor on absenteeism frankly as on all of our measures but it's still but it's complicated correlation that's right but and it and it it raises the problem of of complexity other comments here

[02:27:30] okay uh any comments on the preferences among the math either don't like them you like option 2a or you like option 2b any of those anyone want to comment on any of those one one more comment whatever we do today we don't have enough information to make a final decision and we would love to have you give us some information on how would this help us differentiate schools for for intervention purposes how would it help give parents information that's useful to them

[02:28:08] so can we run some sample numbers at some point in this process on all of the indicators we're talking about and and um to me the more interesting one would be the end of course approach just because it's more different we can see what the data does on them the other dr siebert I don't know. I'm certainly not trying to overcomplicate things, but I don't know if 2A and 2B are mutually exclusive, especially looking at middle school math and what I explained earlier, the desire to have children challenge themselves, get high school credits as they can.

[02:28:46] Virginia has an excellent code provision that a middle school student who does not pass or does poorly on a high school credit bearing course, families can take that off their transcript. It's like it never happened. So it's a real incentive for young people in middle school to challenge themselves. So I I want to make sure that we keep that opportunity for young people to challenge themselves.

[02:29:03] They get credit. They can take it off their transcript if it hurt doesn't hurt them. I I think that the idea I I I I don't think 2a2b or mutually exists. That's actually that's actually that's exactly the comment I was gonna make, and I was gonna cite the that we do encourage kids to take this risk, and and we want to make sure it's that it that it's parallel.

[02:29:24] So I do think there's some thinking there, but I think this is the right way to go in terms of thinking about indicators. And then we need to get to like the best ones and worry about perverse incentives. And I do like, I think we should call out the logic of we're going to focus on literacy in fourth grade.

[02:29:39] We're going to focus on math in eighth grade. These are like key points that tell us a lot about how prepared kids are. And so I think there's, we'll get the individual things, we'll get them sort of that when we have more information. But I like the approach. I think the underlying logic to it is pretty powerful. All right. We can move on to Ms. Holden's question. Yeah, we'll definitely, as part of this process, eventually have those. We had two weeks to prepare this one, so we didn't get a chance to do it, but that is part of the goal here.

[02:30:13] All right. So the next one is high school. So let's talk about high school indicators. Again, using consistent attendance, the same chronic azateaism metric. Ready to graduate. It's tucked in here, but I'll talk later about how it would be included, but this would be the four-year and possibly extended year adjusted cohort graduation rate for kids who actually graduate and they're in a regular diploma.

[02:30:42] And then I know you had conversations yesterday as the board about the ready for college and career and ready for military types of measures, but for what we could fit on the slide here, it would essentially be looking at the percentage of graduates who earn early post-secondary opportunities, earn an industry credential and high demand occupation, so limiting that in some way, enrolling in college and showing career readiness, as well as serving in the military.

[02:31:08] those would be the list again we're trying to keep some consistency of the readiness indicators going through elementary school middle to high having some coherent coherence across them not perfect obviously but uh that's sort of what's on the table we'd love your feedback and chat these are the things that the the board talked about last time these are the four areas that you asked us to kind of bring back and bring back with more clarity and again like you said in two weeks but just kind of giving buckets and want to clarify these aren't like they're very specific things on

[02:31:44] the slide these are just kind of proposals as we've been talking about is that right thank you my question madam president is a lot just to help us like think about this so we heard this morning i think it was dr braebrand from the superintendents but maybe miss remember we had a speaker who said the asvab should be in a it it should not be an indicator for high school and like leave aside did i miss here yesterday he said it should be included in college and career not separate oh yeah college and career sorry like help us and that that's my conceptual question thank you

[02:32:21] help us think about like what is the difference between like i mean where like the ads to me it seems like that's a terrific indicator that's real it's authentic if if that's a career that you're pursuing like how should we think about where these things live and like the differentiator between a high school indicator and a college and career readiness like that that's it struck me as an interesting it's the conceptual point that we're going to have to think about as we design this yeah i can give two pieces of feedback one is that um per the earlier comment if you all agree we could definitely fold ready for military into the ready for college and career and military i

[02:33:00] think that could make sense um the other thing to speak to a general level i think it's trying to ensure that students are mastering and earning credentials and earning college credits and showing that they are going to be successful and finding the right proxies for what that can be eventually we'd like to have actual outcomes as well um speaking as you know as chad not as representative vdoe on that front but to the point that we can have high quality uh pathways helping all students making sure that all students are ready to succeed dr siebert um first of all i'm

[02:33:36] really thrilled that as we're wrestling with the issue of reconciling complexity with clarity that that we're not over correcting to the wrong side of the road because there's still complexity here in that spirit however i do think high schools are a little bit more complex and and as such i think really the primary indicator of high schools is graduation rate so as i think about the placemat or the mosaic i do think that high school has a separate tile for its graduation rate um and that separate tile for graduation rate um is is pretty pretty darn important we obviously want them to have a resume and a plan and other things these other things get at but i i

[02:34:12] almost of the ones we've looked at so far this is the one where i see graduation rate and again it qualifies we talked last month i think graduation rate includes the students that a school successfully keeps there in a fifth year to get them graduated uh reconciling that in many lives of teenagers things happen so but i i think that um maybe there's more tiles on the placemat for uh high schools so uh again this to make sure i understand it's helpful for me to understand how where we're talking about going compares to where we are because i mean that what we are

[02:34:51] the proposed regs will be a regs that edit the existing standards to what the future standards is going to be a red line version graduation rate is already there right so the question is are you talking about changing something about how we measure the graduation rate and there might be some things we want to do to refine as i think maybe dr siebert is suggesting we give maybe more credit for that fifth year graduation student then one of the questions is how does this align with our federal accountability requirements and obviously we do have graduation rate has to be

[02:35:28] in there because the feds require it so we don't really have any question about that but so i'm assuming our current system has a chronic absenteeism has a graduation rate and i'm assuming and has a college and career readiness indicator i'm assuming i'm assuming i would encourage us to have the new system continue having all three of those and that where our conversation would be most productive is how do we want to change them or refine them and and how does this proposal

[02:36:02] relate to so for instance on the career readiness indicator we do already include the military in the ccc ri but i think it's just participation not passing the test and the the miss dr armstrong yesterday was suggesting maybe we want to narrow the measure to only count those who pass the ASVAL and that there may be other changes we want to make but what I would want to hear from the department is what do you propose we do to change how does this compare to the existing CCCRF

[02:36:37] what are we doing to enhance or improve it yeah we can uh go through that more and also be more specific also in the section the third section where we talk about what specific indicators. The one thing I'll say about graduation rates that we've put on here is focusing in on the four-year and possibly extended year adjusted cohort rate, but not giving credit for non-standard diplomas or GEDs in this accountability system. And how does that compare to what we do currently?

[02:37:05] The current accreditation system does include non-standard diplomas and GEDs. We're working to find the number of students that I applied to and whether they're in traditional high schools or whether in alternative high schools and whether alternative high schools might have a different accountability system. So it may not be a big deal for the main standard accountability system.

[02:37:25] Well, again, what's most helpful to us is what are you proposing to change? And on the graduation rate specifically, how do the proponents relate to federal accountability? Because one of the things we wrestled with before, and we were not successful entirely on this, but to the extent our

accountability system doesn't align fully with the federal mandates, then we end up having two systems and two systems is not great for simplicity and transparency madam president is it this is an important point of the graduation rate it's been a long-running issue to it my understanding is it's a correct me if this is wrong the federal they don't recognize a number

[02:38:03] of the so the i'm trying i'm struggling with the right word i know but i think maybe it is rigorous like our the federal system is more rigorous in terms of what actually counts as a graduation graduate under their metrics than than what we count and so there's a there's a mismatch there and that this would align us with the federal standard is that right that's right so the federal standard is the four-year adjusted cohort graduation rates you can also have flexibility to add extended years so five year even six years if you want to but uh yeah uh the graduation rate of standard diplomas so for virginia that would mean standard diplomas and advanced studies diplomas

[02:38:39] correct okay miss ashton um so dr coons and mr chairman i um i this just hit me so i apologize for not raising this earlier when i we're looking at elementary and middle those were indicators that you have when the kids are with us there's this ready for college and career is kind of after they leave so it it made me wonder what are the indicators for high school kids when they're they're with us like AP, SAT, and I don't know how complicated that means, but it just makes me think like, okay, well, they're out now, but there's nothing we can do when they're

[02:39:18] gone. So I can answer a little bit of that, which is that some of the early post-secondary opportunities would be measuring things that they do while they're in high school. So that would be similar to what Dr. Armstrong presented us with yesterday. And in addition, Chad, just so that you know, we did have a little bit of a conversation at the end of Dr. Armstrong's presentation to suggest that we may want to add some piece somewhere that's about civic readiness.

[02:39:48] And so I think that would be probably, I mean, the will of the board to add a civic readiness component here that commits to the Commonwealth that we are very much, we find that our students need to be prepared to be good responsible and um engaged citizens dr armstrong do you want to add anything to to this conversation certainly and i appreciate you all again revisiting this we

[02:40:25] we started a lot of this in detail yesterday afternoon and um someone made the point just a few minutes ago that the work we do from here on out is is taking this and really adding detail to it in fleshing out all these details and of course that idea around the civic dimension of our ccri is going to be important something we definitely can work to improve and to find better because right now i don't think that is very well defined in this and um i'm seeing what we talked about yesterday and what we're seeing here which i was hoping for is lining up nicely i just think we have to go

[02:41:02] through this and really work out all those fine-tuned details here in the agency so so so in other words um i like the way that you're forming this uh conversation a little bit more for us these are these are not fully defined as far as what specifically we are going to absolutely commit to but more about um the skeletal part of this process rather than the specifics so i appreciate that thank you talk about asvap scores credentials there is still some work to be done thank you

[02:41:38] and if i may miss holton our current system does credit work-based learning with some pretty specific guidelines as to what that means as one form of cccri so one decision should we should make is are we going to keep that and actually i did go back and look and the one thing that's closest thing we have to any indicator of civic readiness now is there is a service-based learning component as well and i don't

know what the heck that even means uh the one thing we don't have in it at all now here is we don't have this is ashton's point we don't have the actually enrolled

[02:42:14] in college so all of the data that our current cccri index relies on our data that we know as of the end of june every school year from our data that our schools currently have access to and can share with us if we want to and it may well make sense to start adding in data on whether they actually enroll but that gets a little tricky uh we because number one it takes time so it means

[02:42:47] do we have our indicators delayed or what or how do we how do we you know how do you factor in the enrollment data that doesn't come in until later later and we do have pretty good access to enrollment data you know enrollment or employment data i think is what i've seen used we have access to that i think through our longitudinal data system we can get it from chev and or the virginia employment commission if they are employed or going to college in virginia if they go to college or employed somewhere outside virginia i don't know how available that data is and so one of

[02:43:25] the things i think it would be useful for you all to do is come back and tell us what are states who are doing an enrollment piece how are they addressing those both the timeliness issues and the data availability issues dr kins miss holton i just want to shout out secretary dara is in the audience and she is leading with secretary slater a major task force a group to connect the data systems we are also looking at different data systems for student work to be prepared to do this so the work under the hood has worked with other states we are coordinating with other states to make sure that we can collect those outcome measures in real time and be able to

[02:44:04] give feedback one of the things our superintendents have told us one of the things that workforce has told us is we have to connect those systems and we have to make sure that they've talked and we've have multiple conversations in multiple spaces and secretary has really worked to lead that work and make sure that we are on top of that so just because you're in the room but also because you've been leading a lot of that work and we are pretty accelerated on connecting with other states who are doing that miss ashton do you have a comment okay oh dr siebert so i i think you use different metaphor here we're still talking about the bucket so i think i'm hearing is we're saying that the the graduation rate could become its own bucket tile whatever we want to do we've got

[02:44:44] figure out what goes in the buckets later if we move ASVAB into the achievement bucket as an outcome then that really collapses readiness down to ready to learn in terms of the ascent attendance again with work to do under the hood there and the college career readiness piece and so i think that makes this indicator probably a little less complex and puts other pieces where where they go i want to come back just for a moment it's like i tried to lift up middle school for the math indicator um i'd like to talk i think consideration here i'm confident superintendent's special ed team will be very mindful of um for diplomatizing we have absolutely got to honor the iep process

[02:45:22] and what parents want i've been in iep meetings back to back with parents of children with significant cognitive delays and one family was absolutely committed to going for the standard diploma all the way for as long as hard as they could and we honored that as a school then there were other families who were like i want my child to be focusing on life skills and independence i want them to know how to navigate the bus system and get to and from work and it's going to be better for them to spend 11th and 12th grade or maybe even their extra year working with professional staff on those skills and so again that that that's a determination that impacts diploma types

[02:46:01] um and impacts and is good by the family family so i just we've got to keep that door open for for children of special needs and families who choose those two routes and again i'm talking about the percentage of children with significant disabilities uh dr steve we can uh absolutely provide more information on that too later dates um are there any other points on the indicators we're going to talk more waiting later so i'll put a paper mark for now um any other comments

[02:46:34] on the indicators on any of the grade bands before we move on thank you um i think at this point i I know that our, oops, I've turned my speaker off.

[02:46:51] I think perhaps at this point, it would be a good, maybe stopping point for us to go ahead and take our lunch, if that's okay. All right, thank you. We're going to go ahead and do that. We will be back at 12.15. Thank you.

[03:15:48] I'm back now.

[03:44:33] Chad, do you have anything more before we sort of bring some things to a, oh, yeah. I don't think so. we've talked about the indicators so uh this will give us some feedback on some next steps on developing these indicators going forward and welcome thoughts from the warden any other comments before well let's let's do this i'd like to after this particular conversation i'd like to have to us just to have one piece of this in place um so what i'd like to do is wave first review this

[03:45:10] is a motion wave first review to adopt chronic absenteeism as part of the readiness indicator per federal guidelines and continue to develop high school and career readiness measures with ready to learn ready to graduate college career civic readiness buckets as part of our proposed accountability system and bill has no sound so moved i'm sorry can you repeat them so what i'd like to do is get a motion to waive first review and adopt chronic absenteeism just that as part of

[03:45:50] our readiness one of our readiness indicators per federal guidelines and continue to develop the high school career readiness measures with ready to learn ready to graduate college career this stuff that we've talked about as the skeletal so as those buckets are part of the proposed accountability system so andy made a motion a second okay so your motion does not address the graduation piece one way or the other is that was that so it is ready to learn ready to graduate

[03:46:28] college career and civic readiness buckets but this is um specifically adopting the chronic absenteeism piece as a part of those indicators please so i'm gonna be okay with this if it doesn't tie our hands because i i still think as we move forward i see graduation rates becoming its own standalone significant indicator not within not within ready to graduate but how many kids graduated all the time uh that so as long as it doesn't tie our hands with the sizes and shapes

[03:47:04] the tiles as we build them i'm okay this gives a framework for those pieces miss ashton yep does it also include like the framework for elementary middle as well or just high um so we should probably include elementary and middle but i would have okay with they were all together but so as to discussion to this motion i'm just i think we would have a problem i think we would give the department more clear guidance as to what we want them to bring back to us if we focused

[03:47:42] on what's changing so unless you know so we're not changing anything yet about chronic absenteeism we may want to change the measure per dr northern's recommendation at some point but we're not changing anything about chronic absenteeism we're not changing anything about uh uh graduation index yet but we are telling them to come back to us with further development on the ccc or in

other In other words, I don't know what this motion is, I don't know what just as a general process, if we were to give them guidance on what do we want to do, not in the abstract, but what

[03:48:21] do we want to do differently, then I would understand what we're doing better. Well, I think the question from Dr. Coons would be, do you feel like this, because I think we're, if we could give them very, we could sit here, we get this afternoon debating and coming up with very specific measures that we want to use.

[03:48:39] And then people would say, well, that's too prescriptive. We haven't gone out to the pub, we haven't done that. We can give them this broad conceptual say these are the buckets we want to look at, with the exception of chronic absenteeism where there is some federal policy around it, and go forward and then we're going to continue to develop that over the process as Mr.

[03:48:57] alderman laid out this morning so i feel like i mean did you ask me so that yeah that didn't sound like a question but it was um uh uh do you feel like you all have with the motion that's on the table do you have what you need to go forward and design this and have adequate flexibility to dr sievert's point i think it's important that you're calling out chronic absenteeism and i think it's important for the flexibility in the space as as we all go out in the field and listen to public comment um and jim mentioned this is going to be an iterative process dr siebert as ms holton's

[03:49:34] point i think that um what's i think the big thing that's changing here is that we are separating accountability from a credit from accreditation and i think that that that is the the big win here is that we're moving with this rules-based system where failure to check one box um makes everything come tumbling down that we're we're the idea of losing your accreditation uh because accreditation becomes tied to your inputs i think that now what's the big change here is that we are now talking almost exclusively about outputs and we're doing it without fear of your accreditation we're talking about how we're going to give give uh the account hold you accountable and so i think

[03:50:14] that's the that's a pretty significant macro level change that makes me feel good the other thing i feel good about is we asked probably in july that in august could we have a straw man which effectively what we've been doing is we've been pulling it apart and and i feel we're having lesser straws so i i i think there's been trust in the process so far that um we're not tying our hands that's why i just clarified we're not tying our hands in any way um but we're we're moving towards something but i i think it'd be hard when we're almost building something new i think that right i think ultimately yes there's going to be a red line version of of the standards of accreditation

[03:50:52] but um right now i think that we're building something so new i think it's kind of hard to show immediately how it's different um i didn't expect that well that's why i just call up two things that dr siever just said i think are especially important one is we've immediately gotten into this it's important remember this is in the context that we are trying to break out accreditation from accountability and schools are rightly concerned that if there's a you know accreditation measures change and fluctuate wildly year to year that's got enormous consequences for schools for kids and so i think like we should call that context out again because it's easy it is easy for people to think we are just redoing this is now what the accreditation

[03:51:29] system is going to look like and we're breaking those two things apart and i think that's uh uh that is an extremely important uh contextual piece uh that we need to that we need to break out here is the conversation that we are and are not uh having dr northern i mean i'll just say as the next step and i think

it's been implicit in our conversation um is for the next meetings we should start talking about you know what could be in an ebsco opportunity like what do we mean by that what are i mean get some updates from our colleagues here on what we're doing about defining industry credentials in a high demand occupation what does that mean you know how are we doing on

[03:52:09] our uh you know data uh you know longitudinal system to be able to enroll in college and measure that so i mean personally i think a logical next step is then to be able to dig in to say okay are these things possible what would it take to get there and that sort of thing mr rotherham and just uh i just think the other contextual point no one is saying that like everything we're doing now and measuring is is bad there's not value we've heard a lot of talk like the you know the school profiles are really useful and how do we continue to do things like that a lot of the measures so i think like at least i haven't heard anybody say like we see so there will be some crosswalk there'll be some measures we use now that we think those are working we should we should

[03:52:47] move them forward and i think that that's also i worry as we get into the weeds some of these contextual points get lost and it could be it can be heard what we're doing can be heard in in in in sort of discrete disconnected ways from the total the total project here to to improve these things so i i i'm just really i'm really just talking about a process but i hear you all are i'm interested in looking at a more sort of de novo way of looking at it as i understand the current motion it's that we want to keep some version of a chronic absenteeism measure some

[03:53:23] version of a graduation measure and some version of a cccri measure in our new system that's correct and details to follow that's correct absolutely any other discussion on this okay let's move on and miss kilgore miss holton hi dr siebert hi mr hanson hi miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr

[03:53:56] rotherham hi and chair votes aye okay um i think you continue here right yes uh so the next thing we're going to talk about uh is shift a little bit into what happens with uh the overall system once we've used the indicators so we've talked about the indicators now we're turning a little bit of a corner so in august there were two points of discussion one was about how to make meaning from the accountability system and we talked about a summative versus the placement approach we're going to unpack that a little bit and the second point is about weighting so how to balance the indicators

[03:54:33] to identify schools in need of additional support we're going to take these one at a time so we're going to start with the making meaning from the accountability system the first one uh the option on the table is an overall summative rating for all schools. Summative rating can take lots of different forms. I've got two examples here. The top one is North Carolina's A-F grading system.

[03:54:55] If you look up North Carolina's school report cards, you can quickly find those A-F grades. They're on all of the school report cards very prominently. The second one down is Maryland. So So again, if you search for Maryland school report cards, you find pretty prominently displayed Maryland's five-star rating system on their school.

[03:55:17] So they give a summative determination, they use their indicators, they weight them, and they make a summative determination for an overall rating for the school. Some of the pros of this approach are it simplifies down to one measure, it's very clear, and you can put it on a school report card very prominently.

[03:55:36] You can also create urgency around low ratings. We talked last time about a recent research paper looking at what happens in schools that were identified for improvement. That creates an urgency within the school as they want to respond and improve their rating. Some of the cons of this type of approach, it can be overly simplified and may not share the impact on each indicator.

[03:55:58] It can sort of gloss over some of the differences of how they got that rating. That's the first option. We're going to talk about both these together. The second option is to stop level readings for most schools, and I'm going to come back to that, but that is important when I say most schools.

[03:56:16] So there are a couple examples here are California has what they call a dashboard, their school report card. If you look in California, you get a dashboard like this, so it doesn't have an overall summative rating for the school. It has indicator level information.

[03:56:35] Same with Idaho. Idaho is the bottom one. There's the Idaho school report card. It doesn't have an ultimate determination for the school. It has indicator level determinations. So some of the pros of this is it breaks down components of how a school is evaluated, looks at more of a holistic thing. It's not trying to come to one final determination, and it allows educators and families to see how students are moving and where students are in relation to targets.

[03:57:05] So you can kind of put different benchmarks along the way in each of the indicators. Some of the cons, the one thing I'll say is that it doesn't have one clear indicator for a school. It doesn't boil it down. The other thing is that, I'm going to come back to this most schools point, is that for both Virginia law and for federal requirements, we're required to identify schools for improvement.

[03:57:28] So we're still going to have to identify schools, and that's why we're going to have an indicator awaiting conversation later is to figure out how we're going to combine. minor indicators to come up with those schools that need improvement and what schools that need supports and improvements so this would be whether we want to identify them all schools in some sort of high level summative fashion like what North Carolina and Maryland do or if we want to have more of this category level type ratings and stop there for how we're displaying it publicly the other example I'll use here is Indiana we talked last time about the Indiana placemat and Indiana

[03:58:05] actually does have two approaches. So they have an A through F rating system. If you Google Indiana school report cards, you find a very prominent A through F rating system for all of their schools separately. And they use that for their determinations for school supports and for federal purposes.

[03:58:22] Separately, they also have what's called the Indiana graduates, and that's the display that you all might be familiar with. of the sort of placemat example so this is how they're choosing to display it more prominently on their sites they prefer this sort of placemat of indicator level here's the goal here's where they are falling down at school so those are the different approaches there's kind of two and a half distinct uh options there's the real clear summative there's the indicator level there's Sometimes you could think of it as both in the Indiana example.

[03:59:00] So just to clearly articulate them, those are the options for you on the table today, and let's start the conversation. Happy to take questions. Comments, questions, feedback, Dr. Siebert.

[03:59:17] Madam President, I was trying real hard to wait. I think we'll go first. Again, I think this is not an either or. I don't want to create a false dichotomy here. So I like having these two side by side. i think you you can strike the b off of the letter grade on the green thing and move the percentile rank up and

what you have then is you know hypothetically where there's five bars there on that green middle school so they're using five indicators and based on those five indicators you be coming up with a percentile rank and the percentile rank basically becomes um the the

[03:59:55] indicator um i i really enjoyed what we talked about for lunch and and we're getting into what the buckets are what's in the bucket so this is exciting work i think we could my my opinion we could develop the most elegant well-constructed buckets labels and fake everything is in them and if we try to put a letter grade on them we will never have a conversation the commonwealth of virginia about the buckets so i i i want to see this great work move forward i think a letter grade a letter grade issue uh would just derail this really good work similarly um i stars are are still i think an oversimplification of a complex process we definitely need more clarity

[04:00:35] and so in terms of summer ranking i think if we could agree on again you use this hypothetical green square there's five or six indicators there my eyes are not really good it looks like five and uh that those those are weighted probably they're the five different things they're agreed on they're weighted differently and they lead to a percentile rank for that school and i also think that percentiles resonate with lay people um you know when you take your child to get their their height and weight their annual physical you see what their height is you see what their weight is and you also see it on the graph and you see what percentile they're in and i just think the idea of percentiles brings about a clarity without oversimplifying a grade now i want to caveat that

[04:01:15] this percentile thing is new to me since i've prepared for this meeting and i might change my mind mr rotherham yeah i mean this is a hard one this is where we're gonna this is where the rubber meets the road i i can't help i will observe we have a summative rating system now and everyone loves it because it tells us lots of good news and so people like it i haven't heard i've never heard anybody attack the accreditation system you have a summative rating you're accredited you're accredited with warning conditions you're not accredited and it produces a result that people really like because it tells a story and i think as we've established it tells a story that's not

[04:01:52] quite the right story based on the data it tells a story that nine out of ten schools are doing okay and then we look at the state and we're like well you know what the hell is happening with 40 percent of eighth graders below basic what is happening with our third everything we've i don't need to go through a chapter and verse we've seen it again and again and yet no one complains about that right so that's the first thing i'm left with it's kind of it's there's something weird there and i think we just have to if we're gonna put ourselves forward as leaders in the state we have to like at least name that tension nobody seems to mind some of the ratings when they're making everybody

[04:02:25] likes them. We seem not to like them when they might have bad news. I'm also concerned whatever we do, people will assign ratings even informally. I mean, this is the problem with cut scores, right? You have like a really challenging test and it's a 50 question test and the cut score is set at 20. And people say, well, that's like ridiculous. That's the 20s and F, but actually on a really challenging test, 20 might be a very reasonable cut score to set. But people look at that and they intuitively say, well, that's less than half. That can't possibly be right. I think be the same thing here whatever we do people are going to assign something to it they're going to

[04:03:01] assign values in the conversation and so we might want to think about like getting in front of that and saying and this is what some of these other states and some of the stuff we've done in the work

sessions of like that if you're in this category this is a and whatever it is this is your your three cardinals or three dogwoods or five stars or whatever it is and so we can start to take some ownership of that in terms of what do we want to stand behind in terms of what the the system says, because I do, I hear what you're saying, Dr. Sieber, but in addition to the fact that I think the percentiles can actually be really confusing for parents and they want simplicity,

[04:03:36] I worry they could also lead to confusion about what any of it actually means in ways that we don't intend, because I think everybody around this dais, we want to make sure this system is accurate and fair. I have a few other comments, but since we're on this, why don't we stay on this on this point because I do think it is a it is a complicated one as where the rubber meets the road. Ms. Ashton? Yes, so I'm supportive of a summative rating system as well. I don't like A

[04:04:09] through F. I think that that language is already distracting. I think star or tiers do tell I mean I know we're worried about the worst side of this which is if you get a low tier or a low score But I think it's important for us to think about the other side is if we see which schools are doing it and doing it well, there's something that we can learn from them and there's some best practices and school divisions can call one another and say, hey, what initiatives are you leading for?

[04:04:42] you've made this progress so i think the question i have though is i thought you said indiana does both and so i was going with the no false choices couldn't we do both as well or is what's the cons of doing both that was my that was my question but i hadn't said it yeah the short answer is yes you can do both there's lots of display choices here there's lots of choices to your point about whether it's a threat whether it's five stars whether it's some other uh descriptive term of the categories how many categories there's a lot of choices within both approaches and uh yeah so just to

[04:05:19] answer your question as clearly as i can that you could do a uh rating system that you don't want to put on your report cards for example or those are other choices of sort of how you share information that can be decided later as well so ulton so uh i would actually say i appreciate that suggestion because in some ways you could characterize what we do now as both i appreciate mr rotherham's point and chad's point that we in some sense have a summit of rating already but the reality is our

[04:05:56] real system is uh level one two or three on multiple indicators and i can tell you that the schools and the school divisions absolutely pay attention to all of those levels on all of those indicators so it may be overly complex for parents but as a motivator to action at the school management and division management level they're carrying a lot if they're in a level two on the achievement gap indicator and because it has consequences for them even if they're just at level two it means they have to submit improvement plans and engage with the department in a more

[04:06:35] intense way and if they're at level three then they're accredited with conditions and have even more intervention but if they're at level two sliding towards level three you have absolutely got their attention and you've got it on each and every indicator chronic absenteeism achievement gap reading math science graduation etc so i would say what we have now is almost more like uh um an indiana placement placement system but where each and every indicator um um is getting

[04:07:11] full weight and that may or may not be the right thing to be but it's not i don't think it's fair to characterize this simply as a summative rating system uh i would say if we my question to you would be you know virginia did try as we discussed last month a bill was passed to move us through an a through f

grading system in 2013 i think and then repealed and on a bipartisan basis in 2014 to move to a summative rating system is a big step

[04:07:46] your stars or a through f in virginia and to do it i think we need to be clear that the research that we have reason to expect it's going to make a difference in our kids outcomes so i hear you mentioned before some research and i would love to see the research i have two questions about the research for you chad and the first is does well either the research papers you've spoken to or just more generally states that are doing summative rating systems well in your estimation did they implement significant new resources for the hard to serve school for the most challenged

[04:08:24] schools at the same time they implemented the summative rating system simultaneously with the the rating system and and and i'll while i give you a minute to think about that really what i'm getting at can we piecemeal this or do we need to combine it with resources for it to make sense dr coons so we're happy to provide that for you but one of the things that we've talked about with the board a couple of different times is that we're redesigning the office of school quality and redesigning the resource support at the same time that we're talking about accountability so that is a focus of the department but if you'd like us to provide a bevy of resources that compare

[04:09:01] accountability to school support we're happy to work with chad and others to get that to you if that's a formal request to the board well just to clarify when i say resources i mean resources to the schools it's my understanding that schools the risk is and i think the vsba uh spokesperson the school board association spokeswoman who spoke this morning pointed out the risk that if you do a summative rating system without putting a lot more money in our poor kids schools so that they they can hire good teachers despite being labeled a D or an F school, then you're going to drive teachers away and you're going to make things worse for those kids. And I think that would be

[04:09:40] the worst outcome we could get. And I don't think anybody wants that outcome. So I think the states, I think many, I think we will find, and I don't know this, but I think we will find that many states that have adopted a summative rating system with a single number have geared significantly more resources to the schools, as well as the oversight piece. And so I'm talking not about, you know, are we expanding office of school quality, but are we sending 20, 30, 40% more money to our CDNF schools so that they can address those needs? We'd be happy to provide you the

[04:10:19] research, but could you clarify what you're asking for exactly? I'm asking for... That's something the Department's going to have to work with the consultant. Have schools, point us to a system that is implementing, one or more systems that is implementing a summative rating system well, and tell us what additional resources financially do they send to the CDNF schools.

[04:10:47] Can you give me parameters on what you mean by well so we can make sure we can provide that data for you? No, no, I want you to tell me. And I offer requests for only asking half the things like Florida saw really tremendous results with this. They also offered kids choice. So if we're going to look at this, we can't just be looking at certain sides of it. What's the totality? And in Florida, if a school, I believe if it was a D or an F, certainly if it was an F, the parents were given opportunities. And researchers looked at that. I'm thinking like David Figlio, for instance, looked at this. And these were people who are not predisposed to favor choice. And we're actually in some cases skeptical of accountability. And we're like, whoa.

[04:11:23] like and this is like amber i will brag on my colleague she has a podcast she's got this research minute where she sums up this stuff um in amber's talk about anything so we may get our own amber's research minute here um but we need to look at the totality of what is it these states did because resources can certainly be a piece florida did some stuff around literacy for instance but choice was also a piece and it turned out there was like a salutary effect to that so i i think we need to be careful about breaking these things out we need to look at what these and states did all of the elements.

[04:11:55] - So what I'm hearing the board request of the agency is that you want summative systems who have implemented options and choices and done that holistic system well. - I would say states that have gone to A to F, what is the totality? - You want only A to F?

[04:12:11] - A to F or star. - Summative, yeah, some sort of analogous. - Single summative. And who's done it well? And what have been, for me, most focused on what's the what are the extra finances going to help support the schools that are identified as most challenged and i hear mr rotherham there may be other factors but hopefully you would give us a range of ones because for instance if virginia is unlikely to be moving towards a much bigger choice scenario which is certainly where we have been then then what would

[04:12:47] it look like what's it take resource wise to make this work from what we can learn from elsewhere and i just want to be clear like i think these are implementation resources you want us to provide the resource as you are continuing to move through implementation is that correct i mean okay meaning the operating the maintenance and operation money for that school so for instance when when we have had punitive systems before it drove teachers away from the petersburgs of the world what are we going going to do to stop that from happening? But what I think is missing from this whole conversation

[04:13:21] is exactly what we've been talking about before. And that is the indicators that become a part of this system are what are giving us the specific information of the outcomes that more specifically drive resources. So simply instead of throwing a pot of money at a school division because they just aren't doing well here or there, whatever. Those resources are far more targeted for more improved outcomes. So that could be part of what we asked Dr. Kunz for it.

[04:13:55] What resources do they put into those schools and how do they shape the expenditures? Dr. Northern. All right. These are the states that have used A through F systems. Arkansas, Indiana, Florida, Louisiana, Michigan, Mississippi, North Carolina, Ohio, Oklahoma, Tennessee, and Utah.

[04:14:15] Okay. This is the research on it. So the main system that's been studied has been Florida, but there have been other studies where they say it's a southern state because the researchers aren't allowed to tell you the state because of privacy concerns. All right. So Florida, they found that increasing, with a summative store, found that that pressure changed instructional practices in meaningful ways. But listen to the ways. We find that schools that face summative ratings increased pressure by adopting, I don't know why these increased pressure, but okay, adopted block scheduling, reorganized the school scheduling structure, increased time for

[04:14:53] collaborative planning and class preparation for teachers. We also see evidence that they provide a common prep period for teachers and they increase the district's control over how the budget is spent. So what I see, and here's another study that really was interesting to me.

[04:15:09] This was in, I think this one was Texas. I didn't underline it. This paper examines how school administrators reallocated resources with summative ratings in response to marginal changes and accountability ratings. And basically what it said is they used, moved it specifically to instruction. They moved it to discretionary spending. So once again, like you're seeing, to the chair's point here, you're seeing a restructuring of how the money is spent based on the buckets, right? So if you've got five buckets and your one bucket, you know, is whatever,

[04:15:46] remediation rates, which we don't have, then you're going to pour a lot more money, right? You're going to move money from over here where your kids are doing okay, and you're going to move over here so it's not necessarily that you need a bunch more resources i'm not saying that you don't need some don't put me on the record for that but i am saying that lots of times the existing monies that you have can be retargeted to be spent better and and in smarter ways also this is interesting too like even the threat of having a summative rating like you don't even have to be the school that got the summative rating right you can be down the street you can be you know 20 minutes away but even the threat of having a summative rating actually caused schools

[04:16:26] to improve they're able to use this thing called a regression discontinuity design so anyway it actually has really positive effects now if it didn't have positive effects for kids we might as well all just be parading let's heck no we're not going to do it um but we're here for kids we're here for you know what is most helpful to them and um and and the research is there now to the point about the teachers i get that i mean i'm a former teacher i get that and how does florida prevent that uh losing teachers from petersburg and i think it's because they're paying them more yeah so why why aren't we having that conversation because read the jlark report we are grossly

[04:17:04] underfunding our schools especially in high poverty communities we miss ashton yeah i i think the where i was going with this is i think we should move forward with this and then engage educators in this process and ask them what they want ask the leaders what they want and my suspicion is that they want more autonomy with the resources that they have and they want to be able to provide incentives for teachers who come to serve the hardest to serve students and families and so to the extent that they have more discretion over their resources then that is what is going

[04:17:42] to empower them is when we say here's the money and spend it this way that they feel like you're setting an accountability but you're tying their hands behind their back so i i suggest that and i think my specific which i think we've i think i'm here there's so much steps in this process and that one of the questions we ask is if we move forward this way what do you need what do divisions need what's the autonomy and the resources you need rather than us saying well that's what florida needed or that's what like it'd be great to hear the research but i

[04:18:16] think the uh giving leaders the signaling that they're going to have more autonomy to use the resources to address this would go over way more than saying you're just going to get a big bucket of money but money does count i think you'll be back to kids senator locke has legislation that just passed we have a work group that we're working on around teacher compensation it's a diverse level of work group there are teachers on that work group there are principals our superintendents there are business stakeholders that is something that is being looked at and is being invested in so i'm happy to have that report come to this group so you can hear that but there is a work

[04:18:53] group that is working on that and would be a great opportunity for them to inform you on the research evidence and explorations that they're doing so happy to have that group come here at the end of their study to give that kind of finding for you mr rotherham president i just like to make two points i agree that there are schools in this commonwealth that are underfunded and we continually default to petersburg i'd respectfully suggest it's a lot of schools west of 81 south of 64 that it is and and that is an issue but i would also suggest that the best way to actually start a

[04:19:27] serious conversation pick up on the jlark report and so forth is to start having a more accurate conversation about school performance, a more fine-grained one. And so we've had this conversation a lot over the last year. It's a theory of action. And one theory of action seems to be lots of resources. Then we'll talk about accountability. I think that's backwards. We need to talk about accountability. We need to get this data. And I think that is going to tee up, hopefully, a better conversation about resources than we've had. And I think the peculiar thing is, I don't think there's the disagreement that people think around that question. And as I go around, I hear too many people saying like our schools are like wildly overfunded or rolling in money and so far that

[04:20:06] people are aware of the challenges that's the first point and then the second point this is a contextual point this is something that's nagged after me for a while and so i do just want to we keep talking about this with this deficit mindset towards our educators what they can't do the morale all of this we had somebody who came in and talked to us this morning talked about how educators might not like this morale businesses nary a word about kids about families about caregivers. And there's two problems to that. First of all, our system does not exist to serve the adults. That is not the client. That's not what we're about. It's about the kids and giving

[04:20:42] them opportunities and choices. And the second thing is, it just lowballs our teachers. I believe we can do this because I believe we have fantastic educators. We have fantastic energy that's in the classroom, that's in administration, it's at the superintendent level, and that we're lowballing with this conversation of all the reasons that if we start to report honestly on achievement and start to have these measures the wheels will somehow come off the cart i think that is also totally backwards i believe they will rise to the challenge we have an amazing teaching force here and we should stop talking about them in these sort of palliative terms and start talking about

[04:21:18] them in aspirational terms of what what they are capable of and and that's also it seems like something that's been just very backwards in a lot of the conversations not just um at this board right now but just over the over the years and we should just raise our expectations and i have just great confidence that they that they will they will rise to it dr sievert and in that spirit of the fact that i do think we have extraordinary people who are led by their hearts to answer the call to serve um and i know this wasn't dr northam's words it was the research he was reading the there's the idea that people need to be threatened to do things i disagree with and in

[04:21:57] in that spirit, I think there is a higher common ground that gets us above this fray that really does do both. And so I need a minute to explain this. And I think it begins with kind of what before lunch, Ms. Holt's question about what we're doing differently. So our current accreditation system is basically a series circuit, not a parallel circuit. Now, for people who didn't do physics or don't remember the physics, that's the Christmas tree lights. Our current accreditation system, if one bulb is out, then you're unaccredited. Therefore, the system was built to make sure all the bulbs are really complex and cross-wired. And so we got this. But it's still,

[04:22:34] it's a summative, but it's based on all these indicators, really too many indicators. And it's currently, they're not weighted. So your chronic absenteeism can put you in accreditation worry while you're fine on your achievement and growth. And that just, you know, there should not be weighted the same. So first of all, I'm thankful that we're moving away from the series circuit.

[04:22:53] where you have to have all the switches on. Similarly, I think coming back and just pretending it's one switch is not fair or accurate either. We definitely need to be more clear. So, for example, you can Google consumer reports activity trackers. And the activity trackers, you can then sort them by ease of use or versatility or heart rate monitor accuracy or step count accuracy.

[04:23:17] You can, and very quickly, you can, what is important to you? not not a zillion indicators but on four or five indicators that are important for that tool and and I believe just like all of us who have transcripts and our children have transcripts we ended up with the GPA not one letter we didn't end up with five stars we ended up with an indicator that respected multiple measures and so if if our report cards can give children a GPA if if we can do consumer reports for fitness trackers that at least consider four or five criteria let the user sort by which one of those is most important um i think you can achieve the same things because now

[04:23:53] you can lift up what is the indicator that needs the resources which gets back to the point i think dr northen was bringing up we you do need to apply the resources just saying oh here's three schools that are d's they don't need the resources in the same places you've got to have multiple measures if you're going to make good decisions about those resources go dr northern i i'm in agreement and maybe we're seeing versions of the same thing i mean i i'm for a both approach i'm for a placemat um that has a star rating i think a through f is a bad idea for reasons that we all know um but i and i might talk to some of my teacher friends like how do you feel about a star you

[04:24:32] know because i mean and they're like yeah i mean there's nothing that that doesn't have that negative connotation of an a through f like one star two stars like that's not necessarily bad it's It's just not five, you know, but it's still stars if we want to talk about the optics of this. And I really do like, I mean, I think you're right.

[04:24:49] Like parents need to know, be able to see how schools are doing on five categories. They got one star here. They got five here. That's really useful information. And then, yeah, then it gets rolled up by our weighting. We've got all this stuff to talk about. But then it gets weighted and then somehow they end up with a two or four overall star.

[04:25:06] It's still, you can either look at it. We're not going to just present the overall star, right? We're going to look at all these five buckets or however many we have so that they get more information rather than less information. But sure, just like Consumer Reports, they've got different categories, but you've also got best overall value or something like that that then kind of takes some of those indicators and rolls it up.

[04:25:28] Yeah, that's very much where I am. I think A to F, it's too froth, there's too much baggage, but some sort of indicator, and then you have these other things. I don't hear anybody arguing that it should just be an indicator with some sort of black box behind it, but something that then says, here's what this means this year with where we are, and I do think the evidence supports that.

[04:25:51] I think there's a way through this that can accommodate these different, and I think the issue is just, are we going to offer any sort of summative, again, it can be, you know, cardinals or dogwoods or not. I think that's where we're hung up. I don't think anyone's arguing for not presenting a wide spot.

[04:26:08] And as we've said, there'll be more available, things like the profiles, like, you know, everything we want to know and everything we want in our accountability system are two different things to the earlier point, because if we put everything we want to know in our accountability system, it'll be a mean, it'll be too many opportunities to, it's too much. And so like, I feel like I think we're getting a little wrapped around the axle. And I think there's a way, I think there's a way through this if, but we need to have a conversation. Do we any kind of summative at all? That seems like the sticking point. Ms. Holton. So just a couple of comments ago, you said something about which, what goes first, the accountability or the resources. And

[04:26:45] My argument would be simultaneous, and I don't know why we can't do that now in Virginia, and I would bet that we will find that the states have done would have done accountability. Well, whether through a summative system or through a placemat system or through whatever system states that have gotten results in terms of outcomes for children have pumped more resources into the most challenged communities at the same time.

[04:27:14] And I would urge that we encourage our system to our changes to move in that same direction. And I know we don't have full control. This board doesn't have control over the resources, but we can certainly push the conversation in that direction.

[04:27:30] That's the first thing. Second thing, I am totally nothing I meant to say was meant to not have total belief in our teachers. The problem is they're just not there. I mean, when I looked under the hood when I was secretary as to why nobody was passing algebra in Petersburg, sorry to pick on Petersburg, there was no algebra teacher in Petersburg.

[04:27:50] They couldn't hire anybody who knew how to teach algebra. And we've got to get past that. And partly it was because we had a really punitive system then. and we moved away from the punitive system a little bit but but we still haven't given them the resources to pay enough to be able to attract great algebra teachers from chesterfield to move to petersburg and until we do that i don't know how we're going to get kids in petersburg to pass algebra we're saying two different things because there's a question on this point for you we're saying two different things here on one hand people don't respond to incentives and so they

[04:28:24] don't matter on the other hand they completely respond to incentives like it seems very i'm confused about our belief on this i i would like to get us back to a sense of decorum here please um i would really appreciate it if we could run this meeting the way that we're supposed to be running it sorry through the president um so if you have a comment mr rotherham i had questions on this point before we move moved i want to hear very much want to hear the second point but i had question on this first point because i'm i'm hearing i i'm i'm clear on what our belief is about this at this point okay miss holton i i i don't understand the question well enough to

[04:29:01] answer it i don't have anything to add i do have another question i'd like to ask when the time commits okay go right ahead i i guess i'd like to jump in here though first and just say i i'm a little bit unclear about the assertion that we should be providing extensive amount of resources to an undiagnosed system so by that i mean if you're saying that we need to add to this we're creating a new system and at the same time we're taking resources with it i'm a little bit

[04:29:40] resources where? I mean, this system drives the resources in my estimation. And so if you are creating a system and throwing money at the same time, what's the direction? I mean, I fear that when we are, you know, we had this with our COVID funds and despite the fact that there was some guidance around what they should be used for, we still have quite a bit of money that's sitting out there it's not used and so what we need to discuss here is like i i just don't understand

[04:30:16] the outcomes of this process this accountability system are what are going to specifically drive the targeted very targeted needs of our individual schools and school divisions so um i mean i don't i think we're all circling this idea of resources and funding if we we all agree that you absolutely have to support those deficiencies so i'm not i think we're arguing something that we agree on but i think my concern is are we doing this as we start this new process or when we see the outcome

[04:30:55] so if i may respond to that and then i have a question for our about about research the uh we we already know where the problem is. We know the biggest problem, not all the problem, but the biggest problem is in our poor communities.

[04:31:10] We have huge gaps. And we also know that our poor communities have the least experienced teachers, the least well-qualified teachers in just objective terms of how many years have they been, how many provisionally licensed teachers do they have?

[04:31:28] How many brand new teachers do they have? How many teachers do they have teaching outside of their field? all of those numbers correspond to our high poverty communities and so we know where the need is and frankly any system we give us is going to any accreditation accountability system we use is going to tell us that well okay i'm going to give this to ms ashton here in just one second but um i sort of have to take um i understand that we are looking at a holistic um at holistic data as far as our districts with high poverty numbers, but I worked in the district with high poverty.

[04:32:07] And I worked in a district that was majority minority. And I guess I kind of take a little bit of offense to that because every one of the teachers in my building, every one of the teachers in that division worked their tails off to do everything they possibly could to move the needle for their students.

[04:32:29] And there are brilliant students. there are wonderful families they're supportive families in the in all of those districts so i think we're kind of short-changing the people who are working in those districts day in and day out we know they need resources we know they need help we also know that they are professionals who are capable beyond what we know of doing the job that they need to do and they are doing it miss ashton you know i mean president kreese i respectfully want to call the question around what

[04:33:05] they are trying to decide and move forward on um that being said i think what where i am again supportive of the summative and the work that we are doing is that it makes the data transparent student to student school to school division to division and not all you know big old glob and respectfully there are high performing students in high need schools and so i don't think we can make broad statements about well we just know low performing low poverty schools are all

[04:33:43] underperforming and i agree with your point that the kids who have the least amount of resources need more resources i don't think anyone disagrees with that so to me this discussion is about do we have summative do we have a place mat and if your point is let's also make sure we give leaders and divisions autonomy and resources to be able to execute it i don't think anyone disagrees with that i hope

not um so president precy i just would love to yes i do have one more question i've been trying to ask but that i would like to do before we call the question well the question's

[04:34:22] been called can you ask that during discussion oh i'm sorry i thought we were already in discussion excuse me um so what what we we haven't made a motion on this yet somebody comes up madam president as you work on a very thoughtful motion i think it's important that the motion include that we are going to use multiple measures um i think that that that's how we are going to know in different places anyone can know where the resources need to go by looking at the multiple buckets and and those multiple measures are going to have to be weighted like we're about to talk about otherwise we're spreading the peanut butter evenly across the slice of bread and and that's not what we need the resources need to go where they need so i i still think there's a common

[04:35:01] ground here i feel that it's right here uh that we're i feel confident and it's in multiple measures i i but i think the motion's got to be clear um that there's going to be multiple measures leading to whatever indicator we settle on um that's important so would that be a motion i'll try one out and then we can have more if i understand i'm not truncating discussion we and then have more discussion with some sort of motion do you have one okay great so we we may want to amend it we may want to add to it but um we would like the motion would say that we would

[04:35:40] waive first review and move forward with developing a summative rating for the proposed revised accountability system does anyone need to amend that yeah i've it's gonna be based on multiple measures or I can support it. But I think that this is broad enough to have that as a part of it. That's a friendly amendment. Add that language. Summative rating based on multiple measures. It does. Summative rating based on multiple measures is his proposed friendly

[04:36:15] amendment. But go ahead, Ms. Ashton. I think it's definition. I thought summative rating includes multiple measures, but you just want to explicitly to say summative rating including multiple measures yes because then we'll come back under the hood later and we can talk about how how we how we report this out i think the idea that um we are going to use a balanced system with multiple measures is essential from the outset why wouldn't we say based on then okay based that's that's essentially what we're doing based on multiple measures yeah okay so the emotion

[04:36:51] would be to waive first review and move forward with developing summative rating based on multiple measures for the proposed revised accountability system that's the motion right yes so so moved second okay any discussion my issue now is with with rating um you know we we just talked a lot about how we like the idea of a performance index for the for the case so that's where

[04:37:27] my issue right now is with the word rating versus index so uh it's a comment and a question my comment is i'm a proud product of the richmond city public schools all three of my children got great educations in the richmond city public schools which is a high poverty school division and um so and i've had experience with wonderful teachers there both as a student and as a parent so nothing i said was intended to go any to the contrary and i don't think i said anything to contrary but just put that on the record uh my question on the research which may or may not be

[04:38:03] be answerable today, and I don't know whether this is to Chad or to you, Dr. Coons, but I understand that there is significant research suggesting that a summative rating system contributes to residential segregation. I'd like to know if you are familiar with that research, and if so, can you react to it and tell us what do we do here in Virginia to prevent it from having that effect?

[04:38:29] Yeah, the research I'm familiar with is looking at achievement scores and whether it relates to residential segregation and there is some research on that it it doesn't always look at a state accountability system it's often looking at private vendor accountability systems or rating systems like grade schools or niche and those things keep multiplying so there's nothing the state of Virginia can do to stop that what I think will put pressure or counterweight against it is once Virginia has a again I'm adding a little bit of Chad's perspective on this but when Virginia

[04:39:03] goes to a cleaner growth measure that is more neutral on uh growth and all students can show growth on that measure i think that will push against the achievement-based uh linkage to it to um segregation and demographics so i think that's that's how my head goes to on answering this question can can we get some uh when we come back with the research on the other topics can we add the list to the list, research on the impact of summative ratings on residential segregation, I think that would be an important factor for us to consider as we move forward.

[04:39:43] I'm certain that we can request that. Mr. Rotherham? Madam President, so actually that ties very much. I very much appreciated my colleague, Ms. Ashton's points. She talked about how there are high performing students in high poverty schools i think is super important the flip though that she didn't mention that i do want to call out because i think it's very germane to this conversation we're having now there are plenty of low performing students in overall high poverty schools and i was going to be overall high performing schools and so i think like immediately we get into this like this conversation about residential segregation which is obviously a big issue we immediately get into this like we're

[04:40:21] looking at these schools as modelists and part of what a good accountability system is going to do is get us under the hood to what's actually happening in the schools and i think that's um uh i think that's uh you know that's an extremely important uh attribute of this i agree with with we're out with mr alderman said i feel like one of the other issues that comes up here that i'm confused about is on the one hand we say we don't need an accountability system because people already know and then we say if we have an accountability system suddenly it's gonna it's gonna cause this this change and where people live both those things cannot actually be true

[04:40:56] at the same time these are very complicated issues residential segregation is an issue that goes back decades and has a you know pretty awful history in terms of of laws around property and deeds we all we all know this we're not going to solve it with this but i have trouble as sort of a theory of action of how doing anything other than the thing we control which is schools leveling with people about what's going on in the most effective way we can i don't see how we solve any of these problems without doing that and we did hear from someone this morning who seemed to sort of be saying we sort of shouldn't tell people what's going on because it might lead to other

[04:41:32] bad effects like i think that is the opposite we will never go wrong by being forthright and transparent and then we can go after these other problems which are real i don't think there's any disagreement about but i don't see how we get an inch closer to addressing those unless we're being absolutely forthright about what's happening around performance and outcomes i don't present the motion dr sievert is amending the motion to say some of the index considered a friendly amendment um or people waited waited to the idea of using the word rating because i what the conversation

[04:42:09] just happened comes back to the fact we need multiple measures so we can see where the issues are and where the needs and resources need to go and so that's a clarifying how do what's the

difference for rating verse index for you so some of the states that we've looked at today when you you go to their school report cards, rating everybody first to worst, which again, we have to identify our low-performing schools. And hopefully now we're going to have tools to identify areas of need based on specific areas. So I'm looking forward to that. But more powerful is when you can pick two schools and put them side by side, and it doesn't tell you four stars

[04:42:48] or B. It shows you their four indicators side by side. So it's very intuitive, very easy. One of looked at last month was the south carolina one where you pick two schools in the same district or two schools on opposite sides of the commonwealth and you could put them right there you could look at them so but by having that index um again and whether you call it percentile whatever we end up with um i think people will be able to download a csv pile and sort whatever they want to do but uh i i a summative indicator maybe it's an indicator versus uh i i just caught calling it a

[04:43:22] summative rating uh gives me the heebie-jeebies so it's more about term it's more about terminal it's more about the perception of the use of the word right that helps how it's perceived in a positive light yes compared indicator index wow mr rotherham i'm just struggling like it seems like i mean and we could use we could say a summative score summative measure summative indicator like i'm not sure how any of those are a summative index seems like an index that gets you to a

[04:43:57] summative thing that makes sense i'm not sure what a summative index like what that an index by definition sort of isn't summative so i'm struggling with i'm struggling with the problem that we're trying to solve here or solve for i don't like the word rating all right well i need to go ahead miss ashton you don't like the word rating but you also don't want schools ranked is that right i i think it's going to be fine to rank on any of the four or five indicators we settle on got it okay um and and my hunch dr stever i'm sorry man is that people are going to rank these on a bunch of things and so we should figure out what is the one we want to

[04:44:36] stand behind we're to your point we can't control people are going to download and some of those people are going to come with a genuine sense of curiosity and some of them are going to come with different motives we can't control that but what we can control is this is the measure that we want to stand behind uh as a board and then as a department um and that we want to do that and and then people are going to do what they will but we can say this this is the measure that we think is responsible i like the word measure so i'm going to thank her thank you for indulging me

[04:45:11] okay so uh is it the will to change rating to measure or are we going with the original motion here the mission on the table is wave first review and move forward with developing a summative rating based on multiple measures for the proposed revised accountability system we can't use measure twice yeah the same statement summative measure based on multiple indicators that's essentially what we're doing i'm still struggling with like like we're either going to

[04:45:48] do something summative or we're not and we and we that that's the rubicon and we ought to just like lean into that i'm not sure it matters that much what we call it but i want to be sensitive to to concerns about that but we're either going to do something summative or we're not that's that's the rubicon we're at okay so just by final discussion for me is i'm not ready to vote for it yet without further information on this research on the topics that we've posed so just where i am for what it's worth a no vote is not because i don't want us to go in this

[04:46:24] direction it's just i'm not ready to decide that we want to go in this direction yet okay so the motion is to waive first review and move forward with developing a summative measure based on multiple indicators for the proposed revised accountability system others thank you madam president my colleagues on that because i i'm also looking around the corner of going out in the field and messaging this and i think these words are important in that regard okay miss

[04:46:54] kilgore i thought i was holton no dr siebert hi mr hanson hi miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr rotherham and chair votes aye all right and now we are moving to item g okay um the next item is how to balance indicators to identify schools in need of additional support so uh we've talked about indicators now we're going to talk about how they combine into uh some sort of um summative

[04:47:33] measure um based on the board conversation in august we developed two potential models that we're going to put forward today um you're good they voted you're good they're moving on to accreditation appeals so you did a great job mr alderman we appreciate it but what i think you want to talk through any of these things and move or do you want to move on to g i'm I'm going to talk about the pie charts.

[04:48:07] I'm sorry. I'm sorry. President Sievers. I will indulge as long as it's brief. So we're going to later talk about the pie charts, which is a 40%, which is a 60%, which is a 42%.

[04:48:26] We're not, we are not making any decisions today on this. So would you rather hear about it now or no? As long as we're coming back to this another time. we will thank you now item G yeah we can take five minutes to get everybody ready for item G please

[04:48:53] let's take five minutes how are you this afternoon it's very nice to see you it's nice to see you

[05:01:09] too please proceed okay good afternoon President Creasy Vice President Hansen Superintendent Coons and board members my name is Amy Sika and I'm the director in the office of accountability i'm presenting for first review the submission of two accreditation indicator appeals prince william county public schools submitted an appeal of the academic achievement science indicator for jenkins elementary school and suffolk public schools submitted an appeal for the academic achievement english indicator for john f kennedy middle school for the standards of accreditation

[05:01:48] the state board of education shall provide a process for a local school board to appeal the performance level designation for a specific school quality indicator for any school in the division. Per the SOA regulations, the board shall grant such appeals only in limited circumstances that warrant special consideration in designating performance levels. As communicated to school divisions, the intent of this provision is to provide potential relief to schools that have experienced a significant event impacting performance on an indicator. Such circumstances

[05:02:24] should be unusual and appeals based on this section of the SOA should be rare. For each school that has submitted an appeal, the accreditation indicator is receiving a Level 3 performance level currently. On September 7, 2023, an internal Virginia Department of Education committee met to discuss the basis for the appeals. The committee members were representative of various VDOE offices and consisted of the directors from the offices of accountability, student assessment, data standards and governance, student services and instructional services,

[05:03:01] along with the assistant superintendent of student assessment and accountability and the assistant superintendent of policy and communications. Based on their review of the information

provided by the school divisions, the committee unanimously recommended that the Virginia Board of Education deny the appeals. Neither appeal is based on unusual circumstances that merit special consideration under the intent of the board's regulations. In addition, approving either appeal would set precedence for approval of many similar situations across the state. A summary of the appeals can be found in the board item write-up, and the appeals documents

[05:03:41] as submitted by the school divisions are listed as Attachment A and Attachment B. I will provide with a very brief summary of both appeals prince william county public school submitted an appeal of the academic achievement science indicator for john d jenkins elementary school jenkins elementary staff administered the regular version of the grade 5 science standards of learning test to 41 students who should have been administered the audio version of the test because of this error ten english learner students completed the alternate form of the test seven of the ten

[05:04:20] english learners failed that test typically when a grade three through eight student fails an sol test the student is eligible for an expedited retake if the student meets certain criteria and parental permission is specifically given students are not required to take an expedited retake because this was the first year of the new science tests that they were administered there were two forms available for online administration since both forms were used on these 10 students one was used in error and one was the student's attempt an expedited retake could not be offered

[05:04:57] to the seven english learner students who failed the division indicated that the performance rate for science which they have 58.33 percent was impacted by these seven students prince william county public schools is asking that the seven english learner students be removed from the pass rates for the academic achievement science indicator and if these seven students are removed then the school will be able to earn a level two in academic achievement science based on improvement from last year the videoe appeals committee felt that this scenario did not meet

[05:05:35] the intent of the appeals regulation in addition the committee members felt that it would set an undesirable precedent to remove students of an at-risk student group from accreditation, especially for this reason. Committee members also voiced that there were many students who impacted the rate and not specifically these seven English learners. The committee again unanimously agreed that the request should be denied. Suffolk Public Schools submitted an appeal of the Academic Achievement English Indicator for John F. Kennedy Middle School,

[05:06:09] and the division is asking that the level three four-year rule outlined in the standards of accreditation not be applied to this indicator the standards of accreditation state that if an indicator is a level three through four consecutive years it's designated if i'm sorry if a indicator is a level two or three through four consecutive years it is designated as a level three in its fifth year and until it earns a level one rating. JFK has been in the level two or three range for

[05:06:45] the past nine years. The Suffolk appeal states that JFK was poised to reach the level one benchmark which is 75 percent in spring 2020 when state testing was canceled due to the pandemic. Their rate was 73.21% in 2019. For the 23-24 accreditation year, which was based on 22-23 data, the school earned a rate of approximately 67%. And since JFK has not yet reached the 75% benchmark,

[05:07:19] it earned a level three four-year performance level. The VDOE appeals committee agreed that the request was not a rare or unusual situation that met the intent of the appeal process. Committee

members stated that the SOA contain regulations that are consistently applied to all public schools in the state so that the accreditation system evaluates schools equitably.

[05:07:45] There are many instances across the state where schools are similarly impacted by the level three four years rating, and approving this appeal would set the precedent for many other appeals. In addition, while the division and school staff should be and are proud of the work they're doing with students to raise achievement in English, the pandemic did impact student performance across the state, and JFK's experience is not unique.

[05:08:14] These appeals will be brought before the board in October for a final review and a decision on whether the board approves or denies the appeals. Thank you, Ms. Sipka. We will accept this for first review and see you in October. Thank you.

[05:08:30] Thank you. Okay, so we will move on to item H. Good afternoon again, Madam President.

[05:08:45] I am very excited to reintroduce and introduce for the public that's watching Dr. Andy Armstrong, who was most recently in Goochland County. Dr. Armstrong, I don't know if you want to do some, I know this is a written report.

[05:09:02] Do you have a presentation or is this just written? No, ma'am. I could just hit the highlights if you'd like and take any questions that anyone has. I know that Mr. Rotherham serves on this committee as well. So happy to hear your input too. Please proceed. And Mr. Anson, yes.

[05:09:19] Highlights from the July 31st meeting include a presentation from Mr. Ramos, who is the executive director of the International Association of Lab Schools, who really provided some rich detail about lab schools internationally and nationally.

[05:09:35] It's just an effort for the standing committee to really get more education about what lab schools are, what the tenants of lab schools are as we continue our work. After that, we got an update from legal on a few items related to the application. And we spent the bulk of the time of the 31st, and mind you, this was my very first day on the job, discussing the James Madison University application. And we are still continuing to collaborate with JMU to ultimately have them back before the standing committee. And we have a robust agenda scheduled for October 2nd. And I anticipate that this board will see a few applications come to you all,

[05:10:13] likely in November and December, pending the action standing committee between now and then. But those are really the highlights that we had from our meeting on the 31st. And our work continues and has been accelerated. Really, we have reviewed five applications since then with the subject area expert group here at VDOE, and we will be getting several of those advocates in front of the standing committee months ahead. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong. Does anybody have anything handy? Do you or Mr. Hanson wish to add anything? That was great. Just we're extremely

[05:10:49] grateful to Dr. Armstrong for his work. Also, I think I speak for the whole committee when I say that and also for just the work that Ms. Iwadiska continues to do to drive us along. So that was a great summary and really do appreciate you leaning in on this the way you are. Thank you. Thank you so much. Anybody else have questions? Thank you, Dr. Armstrong. We will accept your written report

[05:11:17] and see you soon. Thank you. Thank you. Okay, item I. Dr. Hollins, would you like to introduce us to

[05:11:30] our special guest. I would love that, President Creasy. Thank you so much. Good afternoon, President Creasy, Dr. Coons and board members. I'm Dr. Samantha Marsh-Hollins, the Assistant Superintendent for Special Populations here at the Virginia Department of Education. As part of our work in special education, specialized student services, we are proud to staff the Virginia Board of Education State Special Education Advisory Committee. I'm joined today by Mr. Michael Willen, who is the chair of your state special education advisory committee, which we lovingly refer to as CX.

[05:12:00] With Michael's background and experience as a parent of a student with a disability, an educator, and in a military-connected family, he leads the work of the SEAC with an unwavering focus on our students with disabilities. And so I will cede to him and let him walk you through the work that they have conducted in your stead over the past year. Mr. Willen.

[05:12:20] And thank you for having us here, Superhandi Koons, Madam President, and board members. Thank you. Yes, I'll run through this. We'll have it all on your annual report there, so I'll go through this, and we'll take questions afterwards if you have any questions. For our last year, for 2022-23, Special Advisory Committee, SEAC, the purpose of the SEAC is to promote the education of children with disabilities by providing advice and policy guidance based on input from citizens and constituent groups.

[05:12:47] The State SEAC is organized and functions in accordance with state and federal requirements, represents various stakeholder groups as prescribed by the Individual Disabilities Act, or IDEA, and our year runs from July 1 to June 30. We have five subcommittees, four meetings per administrative year.

[05:13:03] We take time every meeting for public comment and constituency report themes, and during those times we found that there were some of the common themes were provision of services for special ed students, management and oversight of independent hearing officers,

[05:13:16] The need for services for twice exceptional students, concerns related to the Virginia's procedural safeguards document, the effectiveness of Virginia's due process hearing dispute resolution option, reported concerns with the general provision of FAPE to students, reported lack of FAPE during the COVID pandemic, OCR findings regarding Fairfax County Public Schools not providing FAPE during the COVID pandemic, comments regarding school divisions asking parents to waive their students' rights to special education during the COVID pandemic.

[05:13:44] Our subcommittee discussions resulted in various topics and various presentations that were provided through the State Board of Education. We had topics on Applied Studies Diploma versus Standard Diploma, VSOLs and the SOLs, Transition and Diploma Options, Bridging the Diploma Gap, Incentives for Teacher Recruitment and Retention, Reviewing Higher Education Matrices to Ensure Inclusive Practices are Embedded in All Training, Evaluing Virginia's Due Process Procedures Independently, Priorities with Special Education and Coordination with General Education, requiring all schools to have designated IP auditors and transition specialists, and considering expanding the statewide growth assessments for students with disabilities.

[05:14:24] Our commendations were many. The creation of a committee from VDOE to work on a campaign for creating a full-scale recruitment program and search for teachers using all modes of media and recruiting nationwide, significant increase in on-site professional development and technical assistance to school divisions by VDOE staff,

[05:14:41] The continued support and funding for regional T-TACs, updated eligibility determination documents, technical assistance and guidance dedicated to student mental health and wellness, development of critical decision points, modules for administrators, development of modules for creating present high-quality levels performance summaries for use and development of students' IEPs, creation of websites using YouTube to connect with families, engagement of multiple stakeholders in the development and implementation of the new VAP and statewide dissemination of guidance, ODRAS collaboration with Project HOPE Virginia in developing the intersection of McKinney,

[05:15:17] Vento, and IDAA document. The Department of Social Education and Student Services focus on the recruitment and retention of special education teachers, paraprofessionals, and school-based mental health staff, informing school divisions of Available Cares Act and American Rescue Plan funding, standards-based IEP technical assistance document, and training modules.

[05:15:36] Our recommendations to you all today are to revise the applied studies curriculum and diploma to include individualized pathways of tangible transition workplace skills that add value to potential community colleges and employers. Develop best practice training based on measurable outcomes to guide the school in implementing the applied studies diploma. Reduce the caseload standards based on a reasonable ratios and considering the amount of service minutes in case management. Add an additional pay scale stipend specifically for special education teachers based on case management. Increase competency regarding working with and teaching students disabilities amongst among all instructional staff to results-based professional development

[05:16:15] focused on in-person training and follow-up mentoring establish parent liaisons such as are available for title one and title three or establish local regional special education ombuds positions train pre-k 12 teachers and administrators on the possible harmful effects of a restricted setting and the benefits of inclusion consider allowing five-year-olds with disabilities to be served in preschool programs if it is in the student's best interest

[05:16:39] Develop an inclusion video with lived experience, lived expertise voice that includes the benefits of inclusive practices, potential disadvantages of restrictive settings, and expand state SEAC membership to include representation of military families, i.e. a parent school liaison, the exceptional family member program, their staff as well.

[05:16:57] and that completes our report and we certainly really do appreciate all that you do on a regular basis to address the needs of our there's some of our students that really have a hard time getting services many times and we hope that we can continue to have that cap continuing in the future questions comments there's a lot to cover board members miss holton no questions just thank you for your service and the cx service we really value this every year thank you i guess this is a question, the last item where you're suggesting expansion of the SEAC, is that something we need to act on to add the military family member or is that something the department can do?

[05:17:37] Yeah, that's a great question. We have actually considered that expansion and after a fruitful discussion with SEAC members, the department would consider it's honor to work on that and to expand it. The term expansion is used because federal law requires certain participants and members on state SEAC, but states have flexibility to speak to the unique populations and obviously, as Mr. Willing can contest the the population of our military connected families in Virginia is important and we've already

um entertained some interest on serving on these so we'd love to work in partnership with the office of the state superintendent to move forward with that

[05:18:07] recommendation dr northern maybe a question for dr coons so the work that you are planning to do and are doing with um Mr. Levinson and Pasternak is that intersecting with the work of this committee or how is that going to inform this work or or not yeah so um broad swap they have been interviewing a multitude of stakeholder groups i think i was just thinking that we should probably make sure that they have this document in this reporting information but i think um dr hollins talks to dr pasternak and dr levinson probably on a weekly basis at least so um it's closely coordinated um

[05:18:45] it will probably be a much more robust um set of reports that they provide but we can definitely incorporate these recommendations and pieces in that as well okay i mean the one thing i just put out there i have i have a draft of some of his latest work levinson's and just the need for us to think differently about how we um certify special education teachers you know in terms of the ones who have mild and moderate disabilities versus the ones that have severe and cognitive those are two completely different skill sets and i think that one of the reasons we have a hard time recruiting teachers into special ed is because we make no distinction between all that

[05:19:22] broad level of disabilities so i know that some states are seriously talking about how and why we need to do that and how that would actually help our shortage in that area great point if i may i'd just like reminder that the commonwealth of virginia currently has a bifurcated licensing system for students with disabilities and the teachers for service special education teachers and case managers focused on a general curriculum and then focused on adaptive curriculum which is a specialty area for students with our most significant disabilities but to Dr. Norden's point that has definitely been a huge topic of conversation with many of the stakeholders we've engaged in and so we look forward to seeing those recommendations and working with our partners in

[05:19:59] the department of teacher and licensure any other comments questions thank you both so much for your work thank you Mr. Willard thank you so much thank you good afternoon okay and that ends our agenda and so dr coons i think you have some items for our discussion of current issues section i just want to reiterate some other thanks that have happened over the past couple days um dr rayleigh and i are very blessed to coordinate a lot of work right now and just want to give a couple of

[05:20:38] very targeted shout outs um the data work this year we had more appeals more retakes more pieces from our school divisions and the amount of time that our data team under the direction of Dr. Myers has done a significant amount of work to make sure we had the most up-to-date data, the most concrete and correct data possible for our data release. So a huge shout out to them and their coordination with the accountability team. I think several times today we've heard from Amy Sipka or talked with Shelley Loving Ryder or talked with Katie Carroll and Dr. Carroll's work and being new to the agency and coordinating that work has just been simply outstanding really

[05:21:18] appreciate both of them to get us where we are um dr um sorenson got to present today a little bit on mathematics but that was a major undertaking very proud of the work over the summer the stakeholders feedback and the ongoing work in mathematics and we are excited to work side by side with 24 amazing educators across the commonwealth who are really dedicating a great deal of additional time to help guide our work and support that so i want to thank them um i want to give a huge shout out to the

licensure team they have worked very hard to think intentionally about revisioning our licensure system and launching a new licensure system in october

[05:21:56] but most importantly they're still processing 200 plus licenses a day they have changed the way they do that they have put an intentional focus they have put like a wins board because they know that that when they process those licenses, those are more highly qualified teachers.

[05:22:12] They are also working very closely with DOLE to launch a grow your own program. We will be in Southwest Virginia tomorrow talking with our superintendents, our community colleges and our colleges in that area to really intentionally think about solving some of the challenges in rural Southwest Virginia around licensure.

[05:22:31] So very excited to launch some of that work and talk with some of our school divisions are very excited to think about growing their own teachers and their own communities and those who might not have the finances to go through a traditional teacher program and being able to lean into the apprenticeship work have over 2 000 clinical hours and get paid to do those clinical hours at the same time making it a no-cost low-cost way to become a teacher really excited to stand up the parent engagement office this month we have dr melissa ricky who's a former principal from Richmond Public Schools, leading our work and really supporting our families. I know there was

[05:23:08] a lot of conversation around how we bring our families along in the data work and the engagement and the importance of attendance. So that office is going to be absolutely crucial to us. Very excited about that work. And the All in Virginia website went up today at lunchtime, and there are a lot of parent resources on that website. The playbook is on that website. There is also a portal for volunteers so if you are interested in tutoring in your area or in your region please go to the all-in website on the virginia doe website because there's opportunities for you and your

[05:23:42] organization to help lean in and be all in and tutor our students so we're very excited about that also want to mention that we are ongoing partnering with delegate coiner and the work around early childhood and thinking about the sustainability around our early childhood work and we'll have a fourth commission meeting upcoming and then last but not least our finance team is working really hard thankful to the general assembly for passing a budget last week and for the governor for signing that budget um this morning while we were in session but that is a lot of work for kent dickey

[05:24:17] and his finance team they are working very hard to allocate the additional two percent raise that the general assembly chose that's an all-in 12 percent raise for educators and record investments in our educational system, they also increased the cap, but most importantly, they put $418 million to our school divisions to support the high-intensity tutoring, the literacy work, and the kinds of things we've been talking about over the past couple days. So just want to say a huge thank you to the team and the staff, because they are really pushing hard to make sure things are ready for children, and that we can support the educators and the systems across the Commonwealth,

[05:24:55] but also want to say a huge thank you to the general assembly for giving the additional funds to support our school division at a time that we really need those funds so thank you very much any other comments before we uh close the meeting so um madam president i had mentioned to you and a number of our colleagues earlier that i and to dr kunz that i hope we might have a preliminary discussion today recognizing that we're we've worked hard already today but we're still done

[05:25:30] relatively early uh compared to where we've been recently anyway if we could spend even 15 minutes or so talking about the standards of quality recommendations i wonder if that would help i i'm i'm very concerned that we're not going to be able to get to a quality product by the november meeting which is a statutory requirement as i understand it and uh that we haven't really had any board discussion and and if we had an opportunity to review for instance the existing soq prescriptions as a starting point and here there are there are things people want the board

[05:26:06] want the department to develop recommendations on in addition to that or or want more information about any of those for instance if we is it do we have enough energy i recognize we may not but if we have enough energy left to have a preliminary conversation today that might help facilitate getting this work done in timely fashion so that it can help the governor and the general assembly figure out where they go on resources for schools so i did have a conversation with staff about their preparedness to engage in a conversation like this and they are prepared they've been

[05:26:38] directed to work towards that end for next month's meeting so they have a product in in process for our consideration next month um and i would really like to defer to that since we don't have a structural piece of anything in front of us to work from unless anybody else would like jump in on it yes so i wonder and this may not be possible so i was asked uh in general you know we we the

[05:27:12] board book is always impressively compiled and very well done is is this an area in this one particular piece of of preliminary work and thoughts materials presentations whatever about soq that could be posted somehow earlier um if if that i think that could help us in that regard we'd be happy we send you weekly emails with reading and documents we'd be happy to send some things for you to review and um think about in the weekly emails if that would be helpful and maybe i might not rise to soups memo level but some sort of public communication so that

[05:27:47] um that there's an opportunity for people to think and digest on that because i already know looking at the jlark recommendations lots of divisions uh the goal divisions depart of the state are are slicing and dicing that differently and so i think giving them chance to look at the soq piece would be helpful we'd be happy to put a survey together and put that out through the superintendent's newsletter to be able to glean feedback for you for the october meeting if that would be helpful helpful for me but i don't want to be doing that that'd be great and i think we have gotten some feedback from different organizations but they've been spread out over the course of the year so maybe they could compile we'd be happy to reach out to the organizations as

[05:28:23] well with the same survey to make sure that you get organizational data as well and then the other thing is just to get the existing this we could do right now just send the i mean it's on the doe website we can just send the link for everybody to read the existing prescriptions some of which the general they were the ones that were adopted in um uh 2021 are the existing ones this is a i would be remiss to say that jim is not a superhero and done amazing things for us as usual um under the direction of melissa but we will make sure that we can get you the existing resources and

[05:28:58] bubble those up to you right but i'm talking specifically about the the ones we adopted two years ago as a starting point and then we can hear in october some of those have already been acted upon in part but many of them have not and so for everybody to review the existing ones as a starting point do we want to affirm those or not and then what do we want to add or adapt and and two in particular i would

flag for everybody is one is the literacy uh the uh reading specialists and uh dr coons and i've had a conversation about this i i am i am told

[05:29:36] that the general assembly in its wisdom did not fund the fully fund the literacy act requirements as part of its soq this year there is money in the flexible one-time money that we're hoping local divisions will allocate to it but that's not the same as being funded for the longer haul and so i'm hoping that we will we will in our wisdom have an soq recommendation that specifically focuses on that and there is a reading specialist estimate in here that may or may not be the same as what's required for the literacy act but i'm hoping that's something the staff could address

[05:30:11] and then the other specific one that i would appreciate more input from the staff on is i'm told that our existing 2021 at-risk add-on data is um uh at our existing recommendation about the at-risk add-on fund is outdated and um needs updating and and the stakeholder community i think could help us understand but there was something about the jlark report essentially that makes that outdated. So we need to do a revised, I would ask the department to come to us with some revised language about AFRISC add-on. So just Madam President, having Dr. Solari and

[05:30:50] Dr. Sorensen have offered to give updates on the Literacy Act and some of those things. So I'm happy to have them come back in October and speak to that. And then is there anything in addition you'd like to have presentation-wise in October, including specifically around the SOQs?

[05:31:08] Right off the top of my head, I'm processing too many things. Is there anything else? One thing that might be helpful, have we already had a presentation about the JLARC report? We said we were going to do that at some point. I've gone through the slides on the JLARC website, but that significantly speaks to the SOQs.

[05:31:27] Would that be helpful? We had a presentation on that. I don't know. Did we not? Backing up one step, Madam President? Yes. on i think the soq uh what's been acted on is important like i'm a little confused on what's been acted on not at all in part involved we could get like in addition to getting the the current version just some i don't want i know you know mr chapman's super busy i don't want to add that but just just a simple crosswalk to like the status of those things because i'm not sure i'm completely up to speed on the status of each other mr chapman can you um inform us of the progress

[05:32:06] you all are making in that regard please yeah right now yes oh yeah um i think you know i was thinking later but this assistant superintendent generally i want them to speak to sort of what they have coming for october so that we're aware of of that sure just in general what we're waiting for assistant superintendent melissa velasquez uh who is of course my supervisor uh to update from the policy standpoint since she's over the policy office i will note that on the sharepoint site currently under the board meeting documents there's another folder for board being documents

[05:32:42] where we have compiled historical information on the soq that was in anticipation of the board retreat back in july so some of that data all of the soq prescriptions that have taken place miss velasquez and her her team in the policy office did compile those it's from i think that goes from like 2002 up to 2014 and then part of her presentation that's in the july folders does include the current prescriptions that was presented as part of the retreat but other than that president creasy vice president superintendent coons based on the previous

[05:33:18] discussion at the retreat and in consultation with dr coons we have been putting together the current prescriptions for you for an october presentation and how the ones that have remained unfulfilled if there were others that were filled either through administrative action through federal action so we've been putting that um presentation together we were just doing that the direction to go forward in october to bring to you and as jim had did um did say we did have that um kind of chart in your presentation for the july retreat i know it's been things run together and things have been a while back so uh but that isn't it may have been one of those things that was at the end of the day when we were all a little on our uh last legs but uh may i ask when

[05:33:57] we hear it again in october can you incorporate if we don't have a separate she finish is that okay no no i i mean uh but she had um no i i i it was but i do think that um we we will incorporate a crosswalk if that's the desire um and certainly dr koons can give us the direction that um in terms of what she thinks needs to be brought in in um completion of uh recommendations and we will have a a thorough report and presentation ready for you in october thank you melissa if i may

[05:34:28] If we don't have a separate presentation on the JLARC report, could we ask staff to incorporate into their report the JLARC recommendations as to the extent they are relevant to the SOQs so we know what they are as a basis for our deliberations?

[05:34:48] Madam, we will note that. Dr. Northern? Yeah, and on that same note, I'm happy to send this link to Jim, and there's a, I talked to Ann about this earlier. There was a Hunt Legislators retreat, you know, they host these retreats for each state, and actually Urban Institute read a report, and I don't know whether any of us know, it's called School District Funding in Virginia, and it might be a good idea.

[05:35:13] I've not read it yet, but if we're trying to get up to speed with funding issues in Virginia, we might pair this with the JLAR report and see where they sort of coincide or not and discuss both. I certainly always defer to Kent Dickey on the funding.

[05:35:35] Yes. I will never be in comparison to him, so I won't even try. Thank you. We'll definitely incorporate that. Thank you very much. Is there anything else anyone has? Thank you.

[05:35:52] It's only two months ago, you know, you asked us, what did we want to see in terms of an accountability framework? And we quickly turned that around to you. Would you please bring us a straw man? And I think the people you brought to bear on this process and the tremendous work that's been done really helped us accelerate where we are.

[05:36:13] And so I think we've had to go fast so that now we can slow down and go slow through the Nora process. But what you and your team and your consultants have been able to do in the last two months, I think, is really impressive. Not minimizing the work that's left to be done, but just to do that much that quick at that quality level was appreciated.

[05:36:36] Madam President, I want to echo that. I've said this morning and I've said last night, I've been so impressed with every person that's come for us to make a presentation on your behalf and on the department's behalf. I've been so impressed. And I want to thank all of y'all for your hard work thus far and expediting some of the wishes we've had in the past two months and to get to where we are, you know, I commend all of you and thank you for your hard work.

[05:37:04] Mr. Rotherham. I'd just like to pick up on that before we adjourn. Like we've had some fulsome discussions. I think that's really important. And I think like this board in its current form, like the level of

depth on some of these issues, like Amber walking through the research, that was just phenomenal that like, and so the people who have been willing to step up and people who have long 10 years of service, like, like Ms.

[05:37:26] Holton. And I think that's, that is an absolutely tremendous thing. And, um, I just want to call that out because, and, and to point out, look, if the problems we were trying to solve were simple, like they would have been solved long before we were on the scene. Right. And so, um, uh, these are difficult problems and we're not always going to agree. And I think that's actually healthy. Too much, too much disagreement isn't good, but too much agreement is often not, not good either and i just want to just name i think like the level of the conversations we're having and the care around them and so forth is is is remarkable um it's unfortunate i think that people come for public comment and then think that's the action and then they leave and that's

[05:38:05] actually completely inverted in terms of how the the actual work uh the work flows and and so like we're going to continue to have challenging conversations but i'm just uh i'm extremely excited about uh the board the board the composition and the direction we're going thank you anyone else i thank you all for your commitment and um collaboration as we work um for the students and families of virginia so thank you so much and i would like to uh entertain a motion to adjourn

[05:38:42] and we are adjourned i don't know

